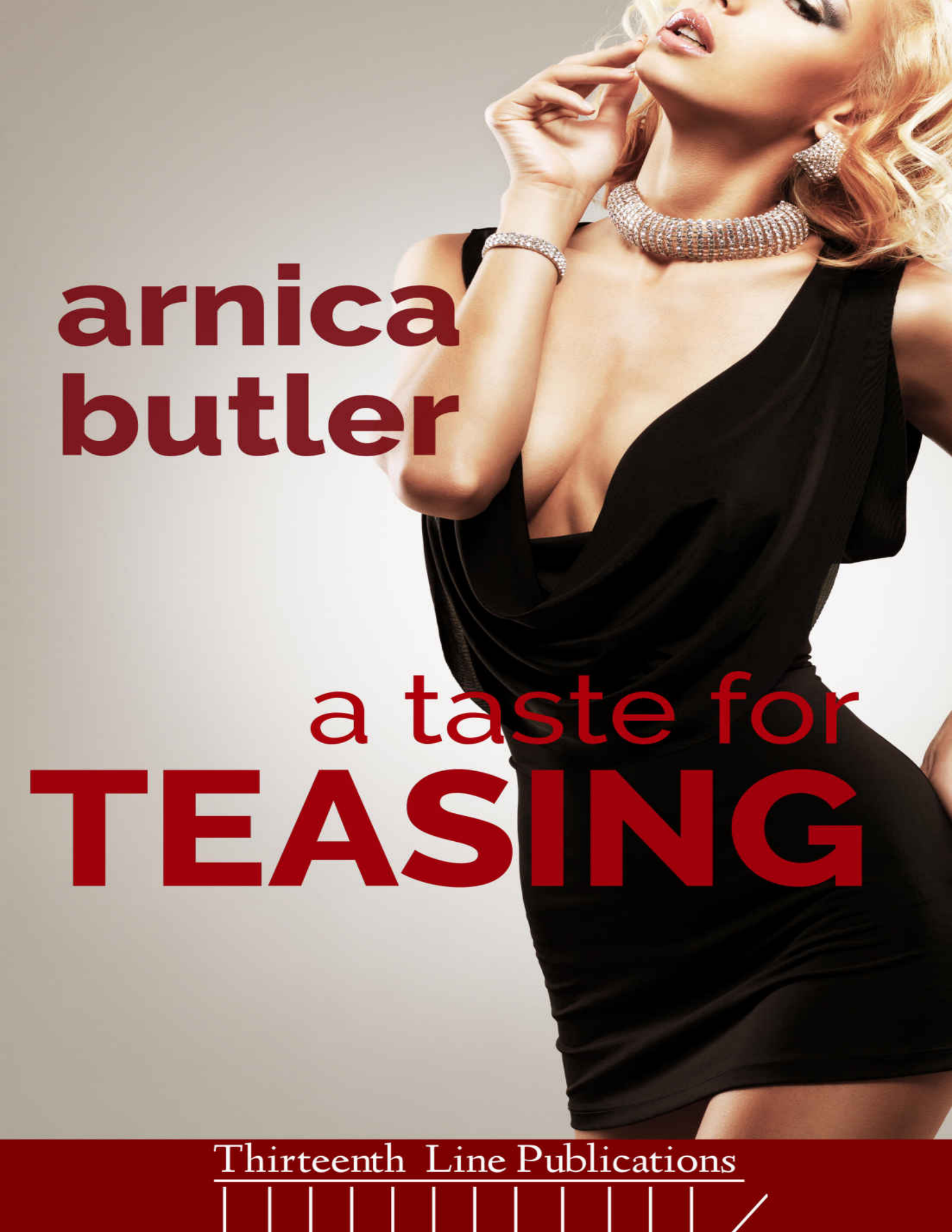


A woman with blonde hair, wearing a black one-shoulder dress, a wide diamond choker, a matching bracelet, and large diamond earrings. She is posing with her head tilted back and her hand near her face.

arnica
butler

a taste for
TEASING

Thirteenth Line Publications



A TASTE FOR TEASING

A Hotwife Erotica Novel

By Arnica Butler

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Chapter 1

I guess the story begins here.

What's the story?

It's the story of my wife, and how she became a hotwife, but – as she would say – it's complicated.

So I'll start where I think things began, in Aspen, about a year ago:

“Come on,” Don said again, flashing his businessman grin: all white-teeth and pure snake oil.

I have never understood why Don has so much success. Success with the ladies, success in business, success finding a parking spot if he wanted one.

I *knew* why, of course: because of the grin and the smooth-talker in him. I just personally never *understood* why that stuff worked on the ladies.

Monica backed me up on this: she said Don had the look of a chiropractor and the feel of a hustler, and she didn't get taken in by either.

But a lot of other women seemed to.

Plus Don was stinking rich.

Back to Aspen:

Monica, who was by this time very drunk, shook her head vehemently for the umpteenth time. She traced the edges of her mouth with her forefinger, absentmindedly sexy. She was so tipsy she had let a dribble of wine roll out of her mouth while drinking it.

“No way,” she said.

But she was laughing, which was not Monica's normal reaction to this line of inquiry.

Usually, Monica found this topic very un-funny, and tried to change the subject by feigning disinterest in the idea altogether. It was a good tactic, and one that usually worked.

Only Monica could make the idea of having worked as a sex line operator sound blasé.

We were gathered together again for a yearly vacation ritual:

Don, who was balding a little, but fit, with an enviable tan and an enviable, slightly padded six-pack. Both bought and paid for with all of his

money, money, money.

His wife, Alicia, who was pretty, fiercely Italian, too thin, and enviably dumb. On the verge of being a raging alcoholic.

Jerry, who like me, was – and still is – just an average guy, though Jerry had inherited a wad of cash and a business, which he was now president of.

And Cathy, who was not the prettiest woman you ever saw but had a truly glorious ass, freckles, and a lot of curly, mahogany hair. Combined, it gave her the appearance of being a ton of friendly fun in the sack.

We were all in the hot tub, getting quite drunk.

There was nothing new about that.

Ever since Jerry had inherited his dad's money, company, and house in Aspen, we'd been coming here to ski, calling it quits early, and getting drunk in the hot tub.

(Don't go thinking that this house in Aspen is like houses you might have seen in Aspen in magazines, or that anyone famous lived next door. It was a lovely house, but it was built by Jerry's dad (as in, he hammered the whole thing together himself with a couple of friends) after he bought the land for a steal way back in the sixties when it was still expensive but not astronomically so.

Jerry couldn't sell it because of the sentimental value, so here we were, in the shabbiest shack in Aspen, getting drunk like big hitters.

Well. Don and Jerry *were* pretty big hitters.

I was lowly cog in the corporate machinery.

Don, who had always had a thing for my wife, started this conversation every year. Somehow, he always managed to get around to it. This year, he had used the presence of Cathy's friend Krista, and Jerry's friend Mike (not a couple, lesbian and super-young, respectively) to introduce the fact that my wife had been a sex line operator.

And then try to get her to talk dirty to him.

"Please?" Don said. "Pretty please?"

Monica rolled her eyes and took another sip of her drink. She was sitting on one of the steps in the tub, so her torso was steaming into the night air, glistening and perfect.

Once a cheerleader for the Denver Nuggets, she had maintained the toned physique of a dancer by never missing a workout. Her rounded breasts, medium-sized but large on her frame, were suspended by a hot pink

swimsuit that usually contrasted nicely with the almond tan she acquired in the summer. Now that it was winter, she was fairer, but it still looked good on her. Her long blonde hair, dirty blonde at the roots and bright where the sun had kissed it, was loosely tied up behind her neck. The tips dragged on the water's surface as she shook her head again.

I was uneasy on the other side of the hot tub, where I was immersed in the water, mostly to sort of hide my gut. I was overheating, and sitting next to Krista, who was disturbingly pretty but also had that feminist, ball-breaking air about her that I found a little terrifying. She was pretty, not butch dyke-y; her brown hair was long and curly and she had feminine curves and a slight frame; she was even wearing a healthy dose of mascara to highlight her eyes.

But she still scared me.

Just being honest.

She was sitting just a hair too close to me, too, and staring openly at Monica with her mouth slightly open, and a grin on her face. She'd mentioned to Cathy, in a joking way, that Monica was her "type," which I had found hot at first and was now finding... well, still hot, but also a little unnerving.

Most unnerving of all was the way Monica was not being her usual self about this topic. Normally, she would have shut it down by now, but that night she was acting a little coy about it. "No, no," she was saying, but she was batting her eyes and smiling a mysterious grin, leading everyone on.

In fact, if you went by their faces, her little act of not wanting to talk about it was making them more interested by the minute.

Don pretended to give up. He fell back against the hot tub and sighed, picking up his wife's leg and bringing her calf to his mouth. Alicia was sitting on the edge of the hot tub, probably in an effort to lose more weight by freezing herself. She had a nice figure, but she lived with a lot of Stepford-Wives types in a weird gated community and didn't work, so she had nothing better to do than get competitive about everything. This went from the high-end jars she stashed her macaroni in, to losing more weight than Amber or Claire.

It was too bad. She'd been a real hottie in the past. Now her pelvic bones peeked out over her swimsuit bottoms. Her legs were still long but

they were starting to look absurd. Also, she'd had a boob job, and a good one, but they were beginning to look a bit ridiculous as well.

Alicia stared vacantly into the rising steam and took another – enormous – gulp of wine.

Krista kicked her legs forward and floated a little on her back. “Now *I'm* sort of curious,” she said.

Cathy raised her eyebrows at Monica. Of everyone there, Cathy was probably the least comfortable with this line of talk. Monica was pretty hard to embarrass, mostly because she'd done almost every kind of job under the sun, and she was pretty open-minded about sex, sexual matters, sexual preferences, everything.

This is not to say she *acted* on all that, which is another story. But it didn't faze her if someone was talking about it. Among other things, she'd been a sex-education specialist in public schools, and she principally worked in middle schools. If talking to pimply thirteen-year old boys about anal sex didn't bother her, nothing else could.

Especially, as you can imagine, the way Monica looked.

Cathy, on the other hand? Closet prude.

Monica's mouth turned into another mysterious smile. Mike, Jerry's much-younger friend, was pretending not to be interested, and I think he was doing it largely out of politeness. Jerry had been down this road before, and he had a pretty good idea of how Cathy was probably uncomfortable.

So that was the mood, with everyone watching Monica to see what she was going to do, and it all seemed like it was winding down completely when Monica sort of growl-laughed, took a sip of wine, and then this:

“So what do you want to hear?”

Her voice dropped like an octave, to this surly, throaty purr.

I should note here that while Monica had talked dirty to me plenty of times, she had never talked dirty to me as an example of a phone-sex operator.

My hand started to sink as I stared at her, and my beer settled into the hot tub, where it eventually got warm.

Don was sitting back up, rubbing his hands together with glee.

Practically. I think he had a beer in his hand, too, or some expensive Scotch, more likely. But that's how it seemed, like he was actively drooling and rubbing his hands together.

Monica swept her eyelashes downward and gave him a grin that, at the time, made my stomach turn. It seemed almost complicit.

To my right, Krista leaned forward, and her smile grew bigger.

“What’s the dirtiest thing you ever said?” Don prompted, without hesitation.

Monica laughed. At that point, her laugh sounded a little disbelieving, almost chiding, and I felt relieved because it seemed like the whole thing was about to wrap up.

“Oh, I’m not saying that,” she said.

Krista laughed, fascinated. “But what was it? Like, the gist of it?” She turned to me, because I was giving her quite a look. “What?” She asked me. “I want to know.”

Monica slid her fingers – very suggestively I might add – along the rim of her wine glass. “Oh, God, it was just filthy, about like, swallowing condoms after this guy blew it up in my ass, and then telling him what it tasted like, really pretty gross.”

She said this without blushing.

Krista was impressed. “Holy shit, that’s nasty.”

Monica shrugged. “I didn’t really pay any attention to it, you know? If it was something like that.”

Then there was a silence.

“So what about something sort of clean, like, an average thing,” Krista prodded. “Repeatable.”

She was kicking her nice legs in Monica’s direction.

There was a long pause, and Monica was shaking her head.

And then she opened her mouth, gave Krista a smile, and said:

“Yeah, just like that, yank on my panties and pull them down to my knees. You can feel how wet they are because I was thinking all day about your cock in my ass. First I want you to get it wet, though, get it wet so it doesn’t hurt too much when you fill up my back hole and pound me so hard your balls slap up into my wet, wet pussy and get stuck there.”

Monica began this monologue in a monotone, robotic voice, but halfway through she seemed to get into it.

She paused, while every man in the hot tub collectively envisioned their own cock deep in my wife’s ass, balls getting tugged on gently because they were glued, by her juices, to the lips of her pussy as he pulled back to ram her again.

“Oh!” Monica moaned, and it might have been comical except that everyone was sucked in by the last thing she said. Our ear for preposterous sounds was turned off, the same way it is when anyone actually has sex. “Mmmm,” she purred. “Oh, it’s *so* much bigger than I remember, oh you’re stretching my pussy out so wide, I don’t know if I can have all of that cock in my ass. Why don’t you try to see how many fingers you can get in there first?”

Another pause.

“Wait, wait, let me do it... I’m going to slip my hand back here and you just watch while you get your cock wet... I’m going to lick my fingers...”

And then, with the entire hot tub open-mouthed, horny, and staring at her, Monica slurped on her fingers, popping them out of her mouth wetly, one, two, three, four. The sound was so effective that I actually believed for a moment that she was going to act out what she narrated next:

“Now I’m going to slip my first finger in...ooooh!” she squealed. “Oh, my ass is so tight... I don’t know if I can do it.... help me out, drop some spit on my hole, that’s it, get it nice and wet, give me some more, there, that feels so nice and hot on my ass, now I can do it, here I’m slipping my next finger in. It’s all the way in, you like that? You like watching me fuck my ass with my fingers, oh, oh, oh... oh yeah, oh, I’m getting so hot I’m going to come all over your cock, fuck me nice and slow... don’t come yet, though baby, don’t come yet because I want a nice hot load of cum in my ass... you want to watch it dripping out of my torn-up asshole, don’t you? So just fuck me a little longer, don’t come yet even when my pussy squeezes all over your cock, like that, oh, yeah, yeah, watch my fingers and you’re going to put your cock in there next...oh, oh...oh I’m squeezing your cock with my pussy, oh fuck, you like that, don’t you? Don’t come yet, I’m going to get my ass ready, oh, there’s another finger in my ass, I’m going to pull it open for you now, it’s so hot and silky inside my ass, I just need to stretch it out for you. Just wait a little bit longer, give me a little more spit, baby, right there in the center of my asshole, I’ll hold it open for you, oh, yeah, oh oh oh, that’s hot, do it again. Mmmm.... now get your thumb in there, you feel it? You want to put your cock in there? Are you going to fuck my ass until I can’t walk? Good, you want me to take my fingers out and suck them off?” And then she did it again, licking her

fingers, while everyone stared. Then she closed her eyes and made a face, a lot like the face she actually made while she came. “Ooooooh...” she wailed.

And it sounded exactly like the sound a woman would make if a man was sticking his cock into her ass. “Oh! Oh, it’s too big, I can’t... oh, your cock is too big, but don’t stop, I want you to stretch my ass open and fill it up with cum, that’s it... Oh, oh! It’s too big. My ass is so full, oh... yes, keep going, all the way in. Yeah, that feels so good. Does it feel good on your cock, baby? It’s so hot and silky, move it around a little, I’m gonna stroke it through my pussy, feel that? I have my fingers in my pussy and I can feel your hard cock through my pussy, mmmm... oh, oh, that feels good. Now fuck me, fuck me nice and slow...there... oh yeah....I’m going to come again and I want you to enjoy my ass squeezing your cock. But then, then are you gonna fuck me, fuck me until your balls are slapping my pussy and they sink right in....?”

Monica opened her eyes and her face went back to a perfectly normal expression. As if she were having tea. “It goes on from there, you know, so he blows a wad in my ass and I had this whole thing planned where he could watch it dribble out, but honestly, no one ever made it that long.”

She took a sip of her wine. “In *fact*,” she said, “I had to quit using that one because the whole point is to keep them on as long as possible, you know?”

Monica finished this speech by tipping the remainder of her wine into her mouth, as the whole group sat here, stunned into silence.

I had a hard-on, and a quick glance over at Jerry and Mike revealed that they did as well. I was wondering if Krista, who was not into dicks at all, was wet, or if Cathy, who was such a prude, was secretly creaming in her panties.

Krista let out a shocked laugh.

Monica shrugged. “You asked,” she said, looking at Don.

“That was, the hottest fucking thing I ever heard,” Don blathered.

Mike shook his head and took advantage of the moment to drop into the hot tub. Cathy looked nervously at Jerry, who was stonewalling the whole party.

Monica looked at me and smiled.

I just sat there with my beer in my hand, an eye on Don.

Don turned to me. “Tell me she talks to you like this in bed. Tell me. Buddy, you are a lucky fucking man. Jesus!”

Don crashed his glass, or bottle, or whatever it was, into my beer, which I was holding half-suspended in the hot water.

I smiled, trying to play it cool. Then I shrugged, as if I just didn't kiss and tell, or something like that.

"Another one," Don said to Monica.

Monica leaned her head back and made a sound at the sky. "Oh God, no, Don." And then she slipped on the stair and went plunging into the hot tub, splashing everyone and getting her legs tangled up with Mike's, and Krista's, and mine, and Don's. And the girls started shrieking and laughing, and legs and skin were everywhere, and Don was staring through it all at my wife.

And so was Mike.

And we all had hard cocks because of what she'd just said.

And then Krista sat up suddenly. "Shit," she said. "Shit, shit, shit... I dropped my glass."

And then we all had to hop out of the tub, and wait, shivering, for the bubbles to die down, looking to see if there was glass at the bottom of the tub. Which gave Cathy a perfect excuse to say she wanted to go to bed, which took Jerry away, and then Krista headed in for another drink, which Mike decided to help out with. Alicia rolled her eyes and said she was going to the sauna, even though nothing had changed for her, because she had just kept dangling her legs into the tub and drinking a whole bottle of wine the entire time.

I cleared my throat. "I'm... probably going -"

"I am *wasted*," Monica said, as though she had just discovered this fact. "I think I should go to bed."

She stood up, and Don made no effort to hide that he was staring up at her ass as she turned around. "You coming?" she asked me.

Don turned to me at that point and made a kind of frat-boy face. "I'm happy to go in your stead buddy," he said.

And then he added a wink, quickly, and said, "Just kidding."

Chapter 2

The thing about Don is that I doubted he was 100% kidding.

He didn't try to keep the way he ogled my wife a secret. In fact, I'd say he did a piss-poor job of keeping it a secret from his own wife.

I put up with this because... well, for one thing it was just the kind of guy Don was. We'd been "friends" since we were kids, though it sometimes felt more like a Lord of The Flies sort of friendship, with Don, the alpha-male, egging me on or jamming his elbow into my ribs or generally intimidating me into a whole consortium of things and situations I'd rather have stayed out of. He was one of those guys who took over the room five seconds after walking into it, and had everybody rank-and-file within thirty seconds. I loathed him and I genuinely liked him, if that makes any sense.

But there was another reason I didn't get confrontational about Don hitting on my wife: I got a weird kind of kick out of it. After all, *I* was the one who had ended up married to Monica, with her naturally blonde hair, her large, wide-set eyes, her 100-watt smile, and her fit, health-magazine cover body.

While pouty-lipped, doe-eyed, ultra-thin girls like Alicia were the kind that ended up being fashion models, it was cheery blondes like Monica that men turned their heads to look at. And for whatever reason, I had scored myself a trophy wife.

Sure, Alicia was her own kind of trophy, but I liked that Don's eyes followed my wife's ass as she walked around the room.

At the time, I thought that was all there was to the thrill I got whenever Don hit on my wife: that I had won something, and I liked to see the proof of it when he coveted her.

But that night back in Aspen, I started to key in that there was something more to it.

Monica was in the shower by the time I said my goodbyes to the hot tub crowd and felt secure that my erection had subsided sufficiently to be able to get out with a modicum of dignity.

I closed the door quietly and crept into the bathroom. It's always been my fantasy to catch my wife masturbating in the shower, and that night

seemed like as good a night as any to realize my dream.

Monica was not masturbating, but leaning backward under the showerhead with her breasts thrust forward. Water snaked down the firm curves of her body: she didn't work out as much as she used to, but the contours of her athletic dancer's muscles were still there, holding up her creamy skin in an incredibly pleasant figure.

Her eyes were closed, but something must have tipped her off, because she smiled.

"I know you're there," she said.

Which is what she always said when she caught me sneaking up like. I'd confided to her, one night when I was pretty lit, that I did it to see if I could catch her masturbating. She had responded by telling me she was surprised I never did, because she did it all the time.

Usually, when she caught me sneaking up on her, she would flick water at me or tell me to stop being creepy.

That night, though, I stared as she brought her finger to the center of her chest and drew it along the line of her breast, down to her navel, and then suggestively followed the line of her pale yellow landing strip, into the folds of her pussy.

She was still grinning. She tucked her fingers between her legs and bent forward slightly, biting her lip.

When I did nothing (other than stare), her eyes flew open. "That's all you're going to do?" she asked.

"Uh," I said, lamely.

She beckoned me into the shower by extending her other arm and curling a finger in my direction.

I shimmied out of my swimsuit, because even if someone had possessed my wife, this was an opportunity not to be missed and I hadn't entirely lost the erection I'd gotten outside. It didn't take much for me to be back at full strength.

I stepped into the shower, and Monica took my hand, guiding it to her pussy. Her skin was hot and smooth. The rubbery-wet of her outer lips gave way to a silky, super-heated center as I explored her. Our fingers met and brushed against each other, and she drew my forefinger to the hard knob of her clit, which darted beneath the pressure of my fingertips as though it were alive before I finally caught it and pinched it between two fingers. I used my thumb to rub against the face of it and Monica gasped.

Her fingernails dug into my back, and she shifted her weight. When she did, she leaned back, and the spray of the water bounced from her shoulder directly into my face. Her foot slipped and her whole body jerked out of my hands.

Monica laughed and turned the water off with her free hand. “Oh, my God,” she said. “I think I’m too drunk for shower sex.”

As if to emphasize the point, she slipped, and I caught her before she fell backward onto the faucet. She steadied herself on my shoulders. “Thank you,” she said. “That was very chivalrous.”

Monica was very, very drunk. The word chivalrous barely made it out of her mouth.

But her hand found its way to my cock, and she squeezed it, running her fingertips over my balls in a fiendish tickle, so I didn’t give it much more thought. Her dirty talk was still ringing in my ears and my cock throbbed in her hand.

Monica stepped out of the shower, still giggling playfully, and almost slipped on the tile floor again. “Shoot,” she said. “No clean towels.”

I followed her, admiring her taut bottom, the way her lean muscle formed a hard sphere and rolled as she walked. Her hair was dripping wet, beads and rivers of water snaking down her body.

She stopped in front of the bed. “I don’t want to sleep in a wet bed,” she said. “So I guess we’ll have to get creative.”

I don’t know if I pushed her or she guided me toward the dresser, but soon enough we were there. A big mirror gave me a nice view of her face and her swaying breasts as she bent over the dresser and planted her hands on the mirror.

I guided the tip of my cock to her spread legs and the dripping burst petals of her pussy, moving in slow circles until I could feel the nugget of her clit on the tip of my cock. Her hot, wet lips closed around the crown of my dick like a sloppy kiss, and I had to fight to stay in control of myself as moved my dick against her clit.

Monica’s lips parted; she met my eyes in the mirror. “Oh, yeah,” she said. “I like it when you rub your cock against my pussy. Oh! Don’t make me come, I want to come with your cock inside of me.”

She reached behind her and grasped my cock, pushing it into her pussy. She was so wet that I slid in effortlessly; it almost felt like I was

sucked deep into quicksand. The heat of her body enveloped me and I could feel that I was already near the tipping point.

Monica pushed back against me and my cock sank all the way inside of her. My balls slapped against her wet lips and her sticky juices clung to them. I heard a wet smack and she backed against me again. She started to buck against my cock.

I felt a ripple, and then a shudder within her body. Her pussy welled up with hot juices and squeezed my shaft in hot waves. I was sent almost immediately over the edge, and slammed her into the dresser as I came. Her hair flew forward and slapped against the mirror as we both suppressed our screams.

We stood, panting for a moment, and then Monica looked at me again in the mirror before a smile took over her mouth. She laughed, and I flopped out of her, taking a step back. Monica's hands slid down the mirror, leaving a streak on its shiny surface.

"Oh my," she said, faking a Southern accent.

She looked around. Her skin was still wet from the shower, and beads of sweat had formed on her forehead and her upper lip. Between her thighs, the moisture was glossy where cum trickled down her thigh, mingled with her own juices.

She gave her hair a toss again, splashing me with lemon-sage scented water. "Well," she said. "I still don't want to sleep in a wet bed. Where on earth have all the towels gone?"

I looked into the bathroom, where the one she had wrapped herself in to come up from the hot tub was crumpled on the floor. Reading my thoughts, she crumpled her nose.

Then she shrugged, and before I could say anything or react, she was striding toward the door. It was open, and she was sauntering naked through the hallway.

I sank onto the bed. I was still a little out of breath; the workout on the dresser had strained my thighs (at 5'6," my wife is quite a bit shorter than me, so this kind of coital feat always takes a little adjustment on my part). I stared into the dark hallway, where thick rope carpet silenced all, and marveled that my wife was strutting around naked out there.

I heard a giggle, then Monica's voice: "Oops."

Another giggle.

Her voice came from quite a way down the dark hallway, where another set of stairs led to a laundry room on a split level, and then down again to a mudroom of sorts where you could take off your boots and leave your skis. There was a closet at the end of the hallway, just before the steps, where the towels were kept.

But there was nothing else that way – except for Don and Alicia’s room, and an unoccupied room full of junk.

My heart rate started to pick up as the seconds, and then full minutes, began to tick by since my wife had said “Oops.”

And giggled.

I sat there on the bed though, not moving, not going out to the hallway to take a peek and see if the scenarios I was imagining were really real. My cock was twitching back to life as I sat there, staring into the darkness, hearing nothing, picturing Don and my wife standing in the moonlight at the end of the hall, his fingers brushing carelessly over her pert breasts, then down lower, swiping through the sticky cum between her legs.

Monica materialized in the shadows, white towels first, and then her creamy skin. She was moving at a quick pace, and her hand was over her mouth. She had about five towels bunched up in front of her and she was still naked.

“Shit,” she whispered, kicking the door closed behind her. It was a heavy wooden door and it caught on the thick rug, leaving about a foot between the frame and the door even after her hard kick. She hurried in and threw the towels at me, then went back and shut the door, a little too quickly and loudly. It made her jump and her hand flew to her mouth again.

“I totally ran into that Mike guy,” she said.

“Oh yeah,” I said, trying to sound casual. I pictured the young Mike getting an eyeful of my wife’s firm body, and my cock twitched again. “I trust he wasn’t too disappointed to see you.”

“It was pretty awkward,” she whispered. Then she made a funny face and sat down next to me. Like she was letting me in on some big secret.

I didn’t get it.

“Down there,” she said. “He was coming out of Alicia and Don’s room!”

I started to get it. But not really.

I furrowed my brow. “Wait. Was Don in there?”

Monica shrugged and smiled her terse, “crazy smile,” for when things get really, really awkward. “I dunno.”

We laughed.

“Well,” Monica said, hopping up and taking a towel to dry herself off. “At least she’s getting – oh, no!”

I was much, much more interested in the original end of that sentence than I was in whatever had made Monica interrupt herself.

She pointed at the bed. “I soaked it anyway,” she complained.

I resisted the urge to make a joke about the “soaking” bit. “It’s fine,” I said. “Go ahead and finish what you were going to say?”

Monica had a towel up on her head now and was drunkenly drying her hair. She pulled it off her head and her blonde hair was a tangled, wild mess. It was very sexy.

“About what?” she said.

“About Mike? And Alicia?”

She looked confused. “About... what *was* I going to say?”

“You said, ‘at least she’s getting...’ And then you cut yourself off.”

Monica stared out the window. Then she shook her head. “Oh man,” she said. “I really had too much. I don’t know.” She flopped on the bed and rolled around to get herself under the covers.

I gathered up the wet towels and hung them up, then slipped in next to her. I turned off the light and felt under the sheets for her body, hoping to arouse her again, but she was barely coherent as she stroked the top of my hands and said, “I love you.”

So I let it go.

Anyway, the room was spinning, and so were my thoughts.

“I think I’m going to die,” Monica complained from under a pillow as the sunlight outside got too bright to ignore. A fresh snow had fallen, and the sky was a cloudless blue. You could tell by the glaring white that was blasting the sun into our faces, even though our window faced west.

I turned in the bed to spoon Monica, pulling slightly on her shoulder to get her back against my chest. Her hair was still damp, still lemony-sagey, but her skin was warm and dry against me, all the silky inches of it she had taken on a walk around the house last night.

“You got pretty wild, there, tiger,” I said, kissing her earlobe.

Monica's eyes flew open. "Oh, God," she whispered. She brought a hand to her head. "Oh, no. It's all coming back to me..."

I kissed her neck. "How much did you have to drink?"

Monica pulled another pillow over her head. "Oh, I can't face it, I can't believe I did that."

I slid a hand down her waist. "I don't think any of the guys are complaining," I said.

In the sober light of day, however, Monica's dirty talk in the hot tub had a pretty raunchy afterglow to it. I couldn't decide if I liked it or not.

And then there was the matter of Mike seeing her in the hall, naked.

The idea turned me on, and my cock got hard against Monica's back. "Say," I said, sliding my hand down the front of her body. "I know a really good hangover cure..."

Monica groaned and pushed my hand away. "Oh, God," she said. "I can't even think about that now. My head is going to explode."

I rolled out of bed. Monica wasn't a huge drinker, but when she got going she had a tendency to overdo it. "I shall find you some Ibuprofen," I said. "And a Coke. And a piece of bread."

Monica waved her hand above her pillow-covered head. "Oh God, thank you, you are the best man in the world."

I surveyed her legs, hanging out of the covers, and enjoyed the view for a moment, before I sucked in my chest and looked at myself in the mirror.

I *wasn't* really the best man in the world: I wasn't the best-looking, or the best-paid, or the funniest or most suave. But somehow, in spite of all that, I had a really hot wife.

I stepped into the hallway and hung a right, which took me down another long hallway to the kitchen. It was off to the side in a large room with vaulted ceilings, where a huge fireplace dominated a medium-sized living room with leather couches and ski paraphernalia hanging on the wall. It looked very cozy in a picture but it was actually quite cold, and the fireplace was off so it was even worse.

"Brr," a voice said behind me, making me jump.

I turned around quickly. It was Mike. "Hey man," he said. "You know how to turn this thing on?" He pointed at the fireplace.

He was in boxer shorts only, and once again I felt like socking the guy for walking around with his lean youth on display. He had the lanky, muscly

appearance that lingers in your early twenties and is gone no matter what you do by the time you turn thirty. His skin was tan and he had dark black hair. I stifled the urge to tell him to put on a shirt.

I crossed the room and turned on the gas, then went to the kitchen area looking for a Coke for Monica. It was the only time she drank Coke, when she'd gotten shit-housed the night before.

Then I fished through the cupboard above the fridge for some painkillers. They were all expired.

"Watcha lookin' for?" Mike asked, with a yawn. He lost interest in the question immediately and looked outside. "There's gonna be great freshy for it today."

"Monica needs some Ibuprofen," I said. "You don't have any do you?"

Mike laughed. "Man, I bet." He folded his muscled arms over his chest and leaned on the edge of the hearth, lifting his legs, so that his whole body was taut and firm. "I'll go check it," he said.

I couldn't help myself. "Heard you guys ran into each other last night."

This caught him off-guard.

He put his fingers in his hair and looked bashful. "Yeah, well..." His eyes darted to the hallway where our room (and Don and Alicia's) were. He shrugged. "I'll go look for that Ibuprofen, dog."

He hopped onto his feet and booked it to the stairs that led down to the lower-floor rooms, where Cathy and Jerry, Mike, and Krista were all sleeping.

There was no adjoining hallway to the upstairs at the end of those rooms, I noted to myself.

I opened the fridge and the bread box, searching for the plainest piece of bread I could find. I found some English muffins and put one in the toaster. Mike was back with a bottle of Ibuprofen, which he set on the counter. Scratching his head again, he slinked away, saying something like, "yeah, well," and giving me an awkward look.

I took the supplies back to our room.

"I just had a really weird interaction with Mike," I said, as Monica rose to sitting and grabbed the Coke from my hand. I opened the Ibuprofen container with a rattle.

Monica chugged some of the Coke. She made a face as the carbonation filled her nose. “Oh, God.” Then she took another, measured sip.

Her eyes went wide. “That’s it,” she said. “That’s what I was trying to tell you.”

I handed her the English muffin. She took a bite. “He was coming out of Don and Alicia’s *room*.”

“And you were just there, naked,” I said.

Monica smiled. “I don’t think he even noticed. I think there’s something super fishy going on there.”

I looked at the ceiling. “That would explain the weird way he acted,” I said. “But you don’t think Alicia’s having an affair with him?”

Monica shrugged. “I dunno.” Then she dropped her hand. “Wait a minute. You don’t think...?”

I raised my eyebrows. “Think what?”

Monica was animating by the second. She climbed up to sit on her legs, holding the Coke in one hand and the muffin in the other. “You know. That they’re like, swingers or something? Or like he’s one of those guys who let their wives sleep with younger men because they can’t, you know...?” She lifted a finger in a mock-erection.

I shook my head. “No way,” I said.

I mostly meant, no way that testosterone-pumped Don couldn’t “you know.”

Monica was excited. “It’s so salacious,” she said. “Don’t you want to know?”

I smiled at her. “Speaking of wanting to know,” I said. “Last night you said something like, ‘at least she’s getting....’ and then cut yourself off.”

Monica looked at me blankly. “I’d like to hear the rest of that sentence, ma’am.”

She bit into her muffin. “You know I would never say anything like that,” she said, resurrecting her Southern accent. She used this act whenever she decided that she had been too lewd and wanted to discontinue. She had spent two years in the South, at Georgia Tech on a scholarship, and she loved Southern expressions. She especially enjoyed saying “Bless your heart,” in a fake accent.

Apparently it’s a very bitchy thing to say.

“You mean to tell me you were not implying that Alicia was ‘getting some...’”

“Young hot black man? No, no I did not.”

I was stunned. My jaw fell open.

Stunned that Monica had said it. Stunned that it made my cock so hard, so instantaneously.

Monica finished off her muffin, as though she hadn’t said anything of consequence, and swung her legs over the end of the bed. “Okay,” she said. “Right as rain as soon as this Ibuprofen kicks in.”

She stood up and headed to the bathroom.

I heard the water running before I recovered my powers of speech.

“So... uh, I’d like to come back to this,” I said.

Monica was in the shower already. “Huh?”

I went into the bathroom. “This, what you just said,” I said, pulling the door open. A cloud of steam enveloped me. “About a young hot black man.”

Monica opened her eyes. “Oh please,” she said. “If you were Alicia who would you rather fuck? Mike, or sleazy Don?”

“Yeesh,” I said, stepping into the heat with a flinch. But my mind was already wandering away from the conversation. I put my hands on her hips and slid them over her wet skin. ‘I didn’t realize you had it in for Don so much.’”

Monica rolled her eyes. She turned in the shower, her body slippery between my hands as she turned. “You know what I mean,” she said.

“Not exactly,” I said, standing behind her, my cock against her lower back, my hands sliding down to her hips. I bent my knees to reach her landing strip, cup the soft bare folds of her pussy. I grazed my teeth along her neck. “Does Mike turn you on?”

“What?!” Monica said, erupting in laughter. She turned to me, and the look of shock on her face was so incredibly fake I almost laughed.

And then it started to work its way inside of me: the fact that it was so fake, so insistent.

“You do,” I purred in her ear. “You think Mike’s hot.”

“What are you doing, you weirdo?” she said. She elbowed me and got me right in the gut. “Get out of here.”

She was laughing, but there was an element of falsity to it that got me to thinking.

I retreated from the shower, my cock hard as a rock. I wasn't sure what was going on in my mind, except that I was enjoying myself immensely thinking about it. Circling it over and over: the idea of my wife and Mike, or my wife harboring a thing for Mike.

Or even Don.

"So you don't have a thing for Mike?" I said.

I wasn't sure why I felt compelled to say it, what I wanted to get from saying it. I was touching my own raw nerve.

"Stop being a weirdo," she called from the bathroom. "Or I'm never coming out."

Chapter 3

We all dragged ourselves onto the slopes, because we had purchased lift tickets and it felt a shame to let them go purely to waste. Monica frowned on the ski lift because it was so bright, and she looked like she was having a pretty miserable time.

Somehow, I'd escaped the misery. It was a gorgeous day, fresh powder in all the bowls and a cloudless sky warming the air and giving the snow just enough weight to make the skiing easy but still fluffy. We returned to the main lift around lunchtime, and found the whole crowd lying around a table at the restaurant, minus Krista, who was a really hardcore snowboarder and had evidently taken off to do some back-country runs with a gang of potheads in a pickup truck. And Alicia, who only came to Aspen to go shopping and complain about the prices.

Everyone looked green in the gills except Jerry and Mike. We ordered some nachos, and Don ordered a pitcher of beer.

"Here," he said to Monica, pouring her a tall glass. "Hair of the dog."

Monica gave him a look. "I don't drink beer," she said.

"What you need then, my lady, is a Caesar." Don hopped up and dashed gallantly into the bar to order it.

Monica looked at me and rolled her eyes. She complained repeatedly about Don's macho act.

Christy took the beer that Don had poured for Monica and offered it to Jerry.

"Hmm," Jerry said. "Nah, I think I wanna get a few more runs in before I tuck into it."

Mike waved the beer away pre-emptively.

"Me too," I said.

Christy was looking at it longingly. "I have such a headache. But if I drink this I won't be able to ski anymore."

Monica groaned. "Oh, I'm thinking of calling it quits," she said.

"Really?" Christy said. You could tell she was relieved to hear it.

"Oh yeah," Monica said, and she leaned back in her chair and draped her arms dramatically over the armrests. "I think we all know I had a *little* too much last night."

The three of us, gentlemen that we were trying to be, looked down at the table and pressed our lips together. But it was easy to see that everyone was replaying whatever they could remember of my wet, half-naked wife talking filthy in the hot tub last night.

Mike cleared his throat. "Okay, well... I'm in for the back bowls, if y'all wanna hit them."

Don was returning with a Caesar. It was a strange sight, I remember thinking, Don carrying a drink to my wife like a waiter. It wasn't his usual shtick.

But because it was the sort of thing that an ordinary, normal human being might do, I didn't really stick it all together.

He set the Caesar in front of Monica, who frowned at it with a furrowed brow and gave Don a rather petty "Thanks."

But she reached for the olive-laden stir stick and brought the yellow-green fruit to her lips. She rubbed the olive on her lower lip before biting into it with absent-minded sensuality.

"Spicy," she said.

Don brought a beer to his mouth without saying anything.

"The ladies are staying here, buddy," I said. "You gonna hit the slopes with us or what?"

Don leaned back, put his hands behind his head, and surveyed the snow. "Yeah, okay," he said.

And then he slammed the beer and threw two hundred dollars on the table. "Ladies," he said. "Have a glorious time, on me."

Monica rolled her eyes again and picked up the hundreds. But she didn't hand them back. Then she edged her Caesar toward Cathy. "Try that. It'll help," she said.

The four of us headed over to the ski racks. Don had left his skis on a fence by the restaurant, because even in Aspen, his skis were the most expensive ones around. We dropped them on the snow and started clicking in. Mike sat down to get his board on.

"Shit," Don said.

I looked over and saw that his binding was rolling loose over the top of his ski. It slid right off and into the snow.

"Well," Don declared. "That's it for me."

Mike squinted. "There's a shop right over there, fix it for you," he said. "Skis are so fucking lame," he added.

“We’re not all as young and cool as you,” Jerry said.

Don picked up his ski. “Ah, fuck it, I’m too drunk to go up anyway.”

Mike snorted.

Don looked over at the restaurant, where Cathy and Monica were still seated outside, looking pretty hot wrapped up in their snowsuits, their glorious red and yellow hair bright in the sun. “I’m gonna go hang out with the *ladies*.”

I leaned on my poles. I already had my boots in my skis, and I really did want to ski. It was too late to change course, and I’d look like a bit of an ass if I did. But I didn’t really like the idea of Don going over there and hanging out with my wife over beers, not after what happened last night.

“You sure man?” Jerry asked.

Don had already paired his skis up and thrown them over one shoulder. “Oh yeah. I was at the bar since ten. This is a sign.”

We exchanged looks, Jerry shrugged, and skied onto the hill. “Meet you back here,” he called over his shoulder.

Mike rolled onto his board and slow-rolled past me with a shrug.

So I followed them.

Though with some misgivings.

The skiing was great, and then we got stuck on a lift for about twenty minutes after some catastrophic fall at the top. It was fun and then it was cold.

Jerry’s phone buzzed in his pocket around that time, and he pulled it out.

“You get service out here?” Mike said.

Jerry read the text. “Those guys are going back to the house. I guess Cathy’s pretty loaded.”

I looked to the right to keep my face from revealing any misgivings about *that*.

After all, what did I have misgivings about? Monica couldn’t stand Don; she said so all the time.

It didn’t matter; there was nothing to be done but be stuck on the lift with the sun going down and the temperature dropping, thinking about my wife and Don back at the house.

I reminded myself that Krista would probably go back there, and Cathy *was* there. And then there was Alicia, who was sure to cool her

husband's jets.

The lift swung to life, and I almost fell over getting off, which made Mike snort at me and call me something I didn't quite hear, but which had the word "old" in it. I was distracted with a montage of images of Don and my wife, some tame and some really dirty.

I paused at the top of the hill. It was so cold by then I could see my breath. Jerry had already skied off, and Mike was nowhere to be seen. And there of all places, in the cold late afternoon on the ski slope, I felt this sensual energy inside of myself. Like everything – the curve of the slopes, the suggestion of a pussy in the parting trees, you name it – was sexual.

I had to ski all the way down the hill like that. My legs were tired and I almost ate it on some moguls because my mind was so deep in my weird fantasy that I wasn't concentrating.

I was pretty relieved by the time I reached the bottom, which involved taking another lift and cutting back over to the main area. I went a long way around to avoid some double blacks because my judgment and legs were so impaired.

Mike and Jerry shook their heads at me as I slid to a stop at the main lift. They were already enjoying a beer.

"Man," Jerry said. "We were about to send out the patrol."

Mike just shook his head. "Hey man, have a beer, but you gotta drive because we polished off a pitcher waiting for you."

I cringed, because I knew what that meant: they'd order another pitcher and we'd be even later going back to the house.

I jammed my skis into the snow to stand them up and cursed at myself as I did. "Cool it you crazy fucker," I said.

When we got back to the house, Don and Alicia's rental car was nowhere to be seen, which meant Alicia was still shopping, or doing whatever it was she actually did all day long in Aspen. I had money on it involving alcohol.

We stomped into the mudroom and shook ourselves out of our gear. The house was quiet, but I consoled myself by reminding myself that it was not where the action was.

But upon ascending the stairs, the hallway was quiet and there were no lights on, save a light in the kitchen that no one seemed to know how to turn off. When we rounded the corner the flash of a TV illuminated one side

of the living room, but all the lamps were out and the sound on the TV had been muted.

“Hello?” Jerry called. “Those guys here?”

I flipped on a light in the kitchen, trying to talk myself out of a bad feeling I was getting in my stomach.

Jerry dropped down the set of stairs leading to the bedrooms on the first floor. “Cath?” he said.

Mike, completely unbothered by any of this, retrieved a bag of chips from the cupboard and threw himself on the couch to eat them noisily.

Jerry came back up the stairs. He shrugged at me. “Nobody here. Just Cathy, she’s asleep in the bedroom.”

There were at least six thousand explanations for this, and I tried to keep that in my head while another part of me started creating an awful, fantastical mess, in which Don and my wife had not only had a lurid affair but had decided to run off together.

“Huh,” I said.

Mike stuffed some more chips in his mouth before saying, while crunching, “they’re probably in the hot tub. We got any plans for dinner? I’m fucking starving.”

I was making a beeline for the doors to the hot tub, which were on the landing of the stairs to the bedrooms. Expansive slate steps led slowly around the house to a craggy outlook into the trees, and sure enough as I craned my neck I caught sight of Monica’s pink suit, a gust of steam, a splash of water.

I threw the door open, not sure what I was feeling, and walked out. Briskly. Just a little too briskly to be cool.

Monica was laughing. She was seated on the edge of the tub, a beer bottle in her hand, and Don was leaning on the edge of the tub on his arms, his body floating out behind him. His elbow was less than an inch away from Monica’s thigh, just a hair too close for propriety. He was telling a story, or a joke, and Monica had a very genuinely pleased look on her face.

“Oh, come on,” she said, and kicked a foot in the water. She brought the beer to her lips and turned at that same time to see me approaching.

By now the sun had disappeared, the lights were on in the hot tub, and Monica and Don were clearly quite drunk. Monica finished her sip of beer and popped the bottle out of her mouth. “Hey,” she said.

The tone was half surprise, and to my ear, half disappointment.

Neither one of them moved away from each other, so I was sure that was a good sign, but the whole scene irked me.

“What the hell did you guys do out there, ski the whole fucking mountain?” Don said.

“You’re drinking a beer?” is what I said.

Monica looked at the beer in her hand, gave it a little shake like it was a chemistry test tube. “Yeah, well, Don said this one was good. Why *are* you so late?”

“Come and get in the hot tub, Orie. I’ve been getting your wife all warmed up for you.”

Monica rolled her eyes.

The camaraderie between them – real or imagined – dissipated instantly. Monica scooted over and then stood up on the bench to walk along it, toward me. “I should take a break from this thing,” she said.

She stepped out, taking my hand to pull herself up. “Need a towel?” I asked. It was ice-cold out there.

“Shit,” Monica said. “I always forget.”

“I’ll go grab you one,” I started to say, but Mike was behind me with a towel as soon as I turned. He handed it to Monica, raked her body with his eyes, and then dropped into the hot tub with his body rigid like a diver’s only feet first. He cut through the water without making a splash. “Jesus that’s hot on my nuts!” he yelled.

Monica wiped herself down with the towel and gave me a kiss. She was all boozed up again.

“You’re drunk,” I said pointedly.

“You didn’t,” she said. “You didn’t just say that -”

“Hey Mon,” Don said from the hot tub. “Get me a towel would you?”

“Me too, *Mon*,” Mike said. “You got mine all wet.”

Don’t read too much into any of this, I told myself. I followed Monica into the house, not without taking an admiring look at her bottom in her skimpy suit.

“So what time’d you guys get home?” I said. I was trying to sound disinterested, but it totally failed.

Monica, who knows me well and knows my tone of voice even better than I do, looked at me archly over her shoulder as she trod up the stairs.

“Oh, don’t start,” she said.

“Start what?” I said, innocently. “I’m not starting anything.”

“Well, good. Because if *I* was going to start anything, it certainly wouldn’t be with Don.”

We were in the kitchen now, and Monica was opening the fridge. I watched her take another two beers out. Then, and only as an afterthought, she looked up at me. “You want one, too? You think Mike does?”

I took a quick look around the living room to make sure Jerry wasn’t there.

I took a step toward her and placed my hands on her hips. “And what does that mean, hmm? You wouldn’t start something with *Don*? Who would you start something with, then?”

Monica snatched a bottle opener off the counter and twisted the cap off the beer. “I would think that would be obvious,” she said.

Mike.

I wasn’t really sure how serious she was being – hell, I wasn’t even sure how serious I was being – but there was a definite electric tension in the air.

Suddenly, though, she shattered the tension. She stepped toward me and her eyes got wide. “You would not believe,” she said, “what I found out today.”

I moved my head slightly to indicate that I couldn’t even begin to guess.

She looked over my shoulder, and then lowered her voice even more. “So you know how Mike was in their bedroom the other night?”

I nodded.

“It’s because -”

“Hallo hallo, please don’t do any making out in front of me, I am *just* passing through.” Krista was suddenly behind us. She had a sunburned nose and a bright, cheerful expression on her face.

Monica’s mouth clamped shut. She gave me the side-eye, meaning “later,” as she leaned toward Krista. “Hey. You want a beer?”

Krista took it without answering.

“And some aloe?” Monica added.

Chapter 4

So that was it for the conversation about Mike, and more interesting to me, what Monica and Don had done together all afternoon. I wanted to press her on that: why did she seem so chummy with him, when she always professed to hate him so much? She certainly seemed to be getting along swimmingly when I got there. And what was with her drinking beer?

I was really annoyed by that for some reason. It was some petty, semi-ridiculous thing, but it somehow represented a victory to Don. It irked me that he had gotten my willful wife to do something she didn't ordinarily do.

We decided on ordering pizza and Chinese food, because no one could settle on what they wanted and no one wanted to cook. Then we all started hot tubbing and drinking, in and out of the tub and back to the living room, while we waited for the food.

I had a few beers and they went straight to my head: they were a tasty craft beer aged in old whiskey barrels and they packed quite a delicious punch. By the time the pizza showed up I was falling asleep every time I sat down.

I fought to stay awake. The beer had kicked in some seriously paranoid thoughts about my wife and Don. The hostility between them now had a kind of sinister, flirtatious nature in my mind. Like the two high school kids, in a movie, who hate each other so much and then end up married. Now, every time I saw Monica roll her eyes at Don, it seemed less annoyed and more like she was batting her eyelashes.

I didn't want to drag her off to bed and reveal my hand. She was getting drunker (as was everyone, including Cathy, who had woken up and come back out professing to never want to drink again, but was having a beer anyway). Alicia stumbled through the door around seven in an unknowable state of sobriety (since she was a world-class drunk), and started downing some wine she'd purchased just for herself, straight out of the bottle.

I was miserably trying to stay awake, but the hours just dragged on and I got overheated. I started to feel sick so I went in to cool off. I sat down on the couch for a second, on a towel in just my swim shorts, and the next thing I knew I was opening my eyes and hours had passed.

All the lights were off except the kitchen light. Someone had thrown a blanket over me.

I didn't even think about going outside to check on the hot tub. I didn't have a single thought from that afternoon percolating in my head. I just wanted to go to bed – right after I had a glass of water.

I gulped the water, gulped another glass, and then stumbled down the hallway.

The room Monica and I were sharing was at the bend in the corridor, where it took a sharp right and went along the front length of the house to the laundry room and mudroom, passing Don and Alicia's room and the "junk room" that was currently uninhabited.

The door to our room was open, which was strange (Monica is a notorious door-closer; she can't sleep if doors are ajar anywhere in the house). Inside, it was dark. I pushed the door open and looked inside: no Monica.

At that exact moment, I heard a noise down the hall.

The state I was in – drunk, a little confused, with a hangover of strange paranoia – is what led me down the hall in the direction of Don and Alicia's room.

The sound I heard was a low moan, a female voice in the throes of pleasure. When I turned my head to the sound, I did a few quick calculations with my addled brain, and decide that my missing wife was the woman in the room, and that she was with Don, and that all the other people in the house had evaporated or something.

What I felt compelled to do, though, was to creep down the hallway and pause in front of the door with my heart pounding.

The sound had died down: these were very thick doors and thick carpet, so for me to even hear that sound, Monica would have to have been very loud.

I reached for the door handle, touched it, leaned in and placed my ear on the door. I could hear the scuffling and movement of two (perhaps more) people involved in something athletic. This raised my blood pressure another notch, until I had that tinny ring in my ears in the silent hallway. My chest felt like an immovable lump of ice.

I did some more quick calculating. It was bad, sloppy work, but I came to a sort of foggy idea that I could always claim to be drunk and going the wrong way if I got caught.

I didn't consider at the time what a strange thing it was that I didn't especially *want* to be caught.

I turned the handle, slowly and carefully, telling myself the whole time to not let it go after I opened it (these were big heavy handles that made a racket when you opened the door and let loose of them.)

Every part of my body was tingling. My blood felt cold; I could actually feel it moving inside of my veins, the pace of its flow picking up, sending a deep shiver through my core. It was the cold pulse of excitement, of fear, or confrontation. The sort of feeling you get staring down a steep hill of ice and rocks, hunting, or jumping out of a plane. Adrenaline kicking in, heightening my senses.

The door moved forward slowly. An inch at a time, my hand throbbing against the metal of the doorknob, while the patch of light on the floor yawned open. The light was on the room; it was dim: I would see later that someone had thrown some red fabric over it.

My eyes took the scene in with the same deliberate pace I had opened the door. Reflecting on it later, I don't know if I was savoring the scene or analyzing it as though you would a crime, sweeping my eyes over it like a scanner, slowly absorbing the details.

I saw the contrast of their skin first: the pale legs against Mike's chocolate tones. As I followed the shape of the woman's thighs, it was clear that they weren't Monica's. The long, thin thighs were olive-hued, and came together at a glistening dark pink-brown center.

The first sensation I felt was instructive: I didn't feel relief, as an ordinary man might have.

No, instead I felt a pang of disappointment. All the burning-cold jealousy that had been shifting inside of me turned painfully to steam and evaporated.

The thrill left me.

Momentarily, of course, because there was still a thrill in standing there, the door open a crack, watching Alicia and Mike.

Alicia's legs were spread wide-open, and her slender fingers were sawing between the lips of her pussy to rub her clit. While she was prone to wearing some skimpy suits, I had never of course seen her whole body: the contours of her bare pussy, the tone of her labia, the interesting swells and valleys that were surprisingly large and swollen.

Mike was perched over her on his knees, and over the small rounds of her breasts, which had large aureole capping them as though she had been dipped in an appealing mauve paint, I could see the thickness of his dark cock sealed between her lips.

Mike reached behind him and blocked my view of the length of his shaft as it began to slide out of her mouth, wet and long. His dark fingers were intertwined with hers, and he started to play with her pussy. The sticky sound of their fingers mauling the soft layers of her cunt could be heard even over their moaning and panting.

Mike lowered his body and raised it, with one hand behind Alicia's head, the length of his shaft presumably sliding in and out of her throat. But his thick forearm blocked my view. I heard Alicia's moan, trapped in her throat by his cock, and Mike's approval echoed in his chest a moment later.

Alicia's legs began to tremble, and then her body flailed on the bed. She tried to close her legs around Mike's playful fingers, but he knocked her thighs open impatiently and continued to massage her pussy, even after she came, even after she started to whimper into his cock.

He rose up on his knees, and finally released his hand from her pussy. "Keep those legs open for me, baby," he murmured. I could now see his dick sliding from her mouth. Inch after inch came from her lips, a thick black snake that seemed to have no eye.

When at last the crown of his dick popped from her mouth, bulbous and swollen, I estimated that his dick was ten inches long. Fat, pulsing. He took it in his hand and rubbed it over her lips, and the very naughty Alicia murmured something inaudible. She actually smiled.

He dragged his cock down the length of her body, lifting his legs to ease them over her spread thighs. The obedient Alicia kept her legs spread wide as the tip of his dick made a wet path down her belly.

He guided her hands to her ankles, and then pushed her arms backward. At this point, it was hard for me to see what he was doing, but it looked like he was rubbing his cock around in her pussy, getting it wet in her juices. Alicia lifted her head and watched him, her mouth open greedily.

"Don't worry," Mike said. "I'm gonna give you some of this in just a minute. Just hold your legs open for me, you little slut, I'm gonna make you come again."

"I can't," Alicia whispered. "Oh, it's too much!" she closed her eyes. "My pussy's so sore. I can't take it."

My cock was so sore now I wasn't sure if *I* could take it.

"Maybe you want me to fuck you in the ass," Mike said.

Alicia did nothing to deny this. I could see Mike's jaw change as he grinned. "Oh that's what you want, isn't it?" he said. He started to flick his cock around in her pussy lips more quickly, and her cum made wet, sticky slurps.

Alicia dug her fingers into her thighs and chewed on her lip.

"You're one of those girls who like it in the ass, aren't you?" Mike said. "Pull your legs up, get them up there, show me that ass. Get all your come to slide down there and get it nice and wet for me."

Alicia obeyed, and Mike looked on at what I couldn't see but could easily imagine given the sounds I was hearing: her juices sliding down to her puckered ass, wet and shiny.

Alicia held her ankles up close to her ears.

"You ready for it?" Mike asked her. The sloshing ceased, and he guided his cock between her legs.

Alicia squealed, and I couldn't tell if it was because she was coming or because Mike was lowering his body toward her, his cock sliding into her ass.

I could see the inches of his dick disappearing, right there where her ass would be. Alicia's legs wobbled in her hands, and she turned her head to bite the pillow next to her face. Mike kept sinking into her, until he was all the way in. Then he reached his hands beneath her small ass and hiked her up onto his knees, an act which almost surely must have pressed his cock up against the wall of her pussy.

Alicia wailed into the pillow, and Mike began to push and pull her bottom over his cock, fucking her like a blow-up doll while she held her legs open for him and took it.

This went on for what seemed both like an eternity and a very short time. Alicia dropped her hand to her pussy and one of her legs dropped to the side. She leveraged herself on the bed and started to push her ass up against Mike's pelvis. They slapped together violently for several minutes until Mike lifted his head to the ceiling, said "Fuck!" loudly, and thrust deep into Alicia's ass while she rocked against him until she also came again.

When Alicia let go of her other leg, she laughed. It was then that I realized what I was doing: that I had pushed the door open even more for a

better look. I almost released the handle, but caught myself in horror and slowly turned it up.

Luckily, the two of them were still panting, giggling slightly, jiggling in their fluids with Mike's cock still inside of Alicia.

I backed away from the door, quickly, walking backwards a few steps and then, realizing how stupid that was, I turned and trotted down the hall. The hallway was quiet when I reached the end of it: it seemed the two of them had not noticed the cracked door yet.

The door to my room was still open, and the inside of the room still empty. It was then that I remembered that I had never located *my own* wife. I veered to the left at the bend in the hallway and strode to the kitchen, where the solitary light over the stove cast its glow on the empty living room beyond.

I went right, down the stairs to the landing, and stood next to the door, peering into the darkness. My ears were attuned to the kitchen and living room behind me, and the hallway to the right. I was listening for Mike or Alicia, telling myself not to react like an idiot if one of them came down the hallway at that moment.

At the same time, my mind was racing: where was my wife? And where was Don?

The downstairs hallway, which ran underneath the hallway upstairs, was illuminated by a light somewhere down the corridor. At the bottom of the stairs, to the right, was Jerry and Christy's room, the door closed.

At the end of the hallway there was a sauna.

I decided that was my best hope of looking like I had legitimate business here, and to hide from the potential appearance of Mike. I went down the corridor, passing the lit room, where Krista was on her bed, talking to someone on her phone in a low voice with the door only open a fraction. She didn't look up as I passed.

The sauna room was dark. I turned on the light. It smelled of sandalwood and cedar, and I wondered why I had never been down here before. I turned the sauna on and stood in the room, my heart racing.

I wanted to go up and look at the hot tub, I *expected* to find Monica there with Don. But I didn't know how I would manage it with any finesse.

And I wanted to catch them, I started to realize. I wanted to see something as salacious as what I had seen with Mike and Alicia. And surely

that could be the only thing they were doing, if Don hadn't noticed that his own wife had run off with the good-looking, young black guy.

I stepped over to the sink to splash some water on my face. I shook my head at myself.

And that's when I saw it.

I had never been in the sauna, except the first time I came here when Jerry gave me a tour, and then a handful of times to tell someone that dinner was ready or to get out before they cooked. I had never been this deep in the room, and so I had never seen the very large square window in the corner. A large orchid sat in a pot in a glass table below it.

I was on it in a flash. I went to the window, rolled it open with the handle, and peered into the darkness. Impatiently, I went back to slap off the sauna light so I could see better into the darkness.

The illuminated water in hot tub was clearly visible from where I was, and the mist of steam hanging over it. The pattern of light reflected on the wall of the house was still: no one was in the hot tub (or if they were, they weren't moving). It was harshly cold outside; my breath floated in front of me.

Disappointed again, and now beginning to wonder in a more standard way where my wife was, I started to turn the handle of the window to close it.

And then I heard the unmistakable throaty giggle of my wife.

I froze in place, listening to the darkness outside. The sound hadn't come from the hot tub.

I squinted into the darkness when I heard her laugh again.

Then I heard a shriek. A pleased shriek, the kind of shriek a girl makes when you chase her or toss her into a pool or something.

"Oh God!" I heard Don's voice. "Oh, that's the stuff."

Without giving it much thought, I was standing on the glass table and hoisting myself indecorously through the screenless window. I heard the orchid roll perilously on the glass, but no crash, so I must have kicked it and lucked out that it stabilized itself.

I shimmied through the window and onto the snow. The temperature gnawed at my bare stomach and legs, and the cold sank through my trousers to my erect cock. My mind was too focused on what I was thinking about, though, to take much notice of the pain creeping into my extremities.

I jumped into a crouch, my eyes glued to the hot tub.

“Oh my God!” This time it was Monica. “Oh. I can’t take it anymore!”

Another shriek.

Their voices were coming from beyond the hot tub, where the ground sloughed away into the trees. I popped up, and at that exact moment Monica’s white skin appeared: her limbs flailing, her hair wet, her mouth open in yet another shriek. From behind her, a ball of white snow sailed through the air and struck her on the back, exploding around her just as she leaped into the tub.

I dropped to the ground, heart smashing wildly against my chest, just as the water exploded around her. She let out another high-pitched scream.

Monica. Fully clothed.

Well, in her suit at least.

Don’s voice followed, and as I crouched there, freezing, I saw his head bob up from the horizon of my vision. He stood over the hot tub, smiling, and stretched.

Don was also clothed, in his swim trunks.

He smiled at my wife, and then took his hand, which was full of snow, and rubbed it along his arms. “I told you it feels great. What did I tell you?” he said.

Monica made a sound, a bit like a laugh and a sensual murmur all in one, and said nothing.

Don dropped into the hot tub, much the same way Mike had earlier: muscles flexed, body taut, showing off his physique. Without much of a splash.

Then he sank into the water.

I rose up, an inch at a time, to get a view of what they were doing up there. My legs burned with the effort: I was standing in an excruciating half-crouch.

Another pang of disappointment surprised me, when I saw that the two were seated at opposite ends of the hot tub. Facing each other. Smiling.

Not touching, which I was discovering that I was secretly hoping for.

I moved carefully toward the wall of the house, where I figured I wouldn’t be seen. I was cold as hell but it barely registered with me. I was consumed by the heat of watching my wife and Don.

“Admit it,” Don said. “It was a good idea.”

I watched Monica. The slight turn of her mouth, the way she brought her hand to her shoulder as she shrugged. I couldn't see her very clearly from where I was but I knew the face she was making. A flirty, noncommittal shrug; a mysterious smile. These were all things she had done to me at some point, and they had wrapped me around her little finger.

"Admit it," Don cajoled.

"I guess," Monica said, her voice a whiskey purr. She paused to give Don a smile. My cock flexed. "If you like the sensation of having a heart attack."

Don's arms moved forward. I couldn't see where to, or what for. If Monica had her legs extended toward him, he could have easily taken one in his hands to rub her calf.

He pushed them apart, like he was doing the breast stroke.

"I think you're in good enough shape you can handle it," Don said. "You seem pretty fit."

It was one of those conversations people have in bars, as they circle each other like fighter cocks before one of them gives in and they decide to hook up.

Monica said nothing.

It was over the line, I thought. It had to be. Just a little. After all, there was no mistake that Don was flirting with her, and while you *could* make a mistake about what Monica was up to – there was no mistake that she was not actively putting herself in a bad position for a married woman. Just sticking her toe over the line, feeling out the waters.

She turned her head up and toward the doors to the stairway suddenly. "Gosh, *they've* been gone a long time," she said. Her voice had a teasing, complicit tone to it.

Don kept looking at her, his arms now draped over the side of the hot tub, giving her a nice view of his toned biceps and his chiseled pecs. The ropes of muscle moved slightly with his shrug.

"So how does that work, exactly?" Monica said, stretching her own arms over the back of the hot tub. "You just... let her sleep with whoever?"

"Whoever she *wants* to," Don said.

"And then you watch."

Don nodded.

"But you're not watching tonight."

There was an edge to Monica's voice. A little beckon in the way she said "tonight."

Don moved into the center of the hot tub. The distance between them now was tantalizingly small. "I have better things to do tonight," Don said.

My stomach churned. My eyes were glued to Monica. Don moved closer and closer to her.

Monica turned her head again and looked at the doors.

"Ahhhh, whoooo," she said loudly, and stood up suddenly on the bench in the hot tub. By the time Don reached her side, he could only get a hold of her ankles.

Monica wobbled, and looked around her. She found a towel and put it around her torso. "I've had waaaaay too much to drink... I need to..."

"Come on, stay," Don said, and he moved closer to her leg, his mouth opening like he was going to take a bite of it.

Monica stepped backward onto the deck and shook her leg free of him – elegantly, but with determination. "Oh boy," she said. "Yeah. Okay. I'm... gonna go now."

She turned and walked quickly toward the doors.

Don watched her, an amused smile on his face.

What an arrogant bastard, I thought.

I backed toward the window, crouching lower, no hoping against hope that I wouldn't be seen or heard by Don.

I heard a commotion by the doors to the house, and recognized the voices of Mike and Alicia. "Oh, hey, where you going?" Mike boomed.

"Yeah, come on back," Don chimed in.

I didn't hear what happened up there, so I rose up a little to get a look. The door was swinging closed and Mike and Alicia were holding hands as they walked toward the hot tub.

My wife had gone inside.

It was at that moment that I realized she would probably be looking for me next.

I dropped (very ungracefully) back into the sauna room and closed the window. The orchid took another tumble, and I had to dive to save it. I hopped into the sauna, which had heated to a very welcome temperature, and leaned against the wood panels. I tried to steady my heart.

At that point, the heat reached through my near-frozen hands and feet and started to cause me excruciating pain. I clutched my toes and breathed

heavily, considered getting out, decided to stay inside and have a plausible alibi for....

For what? I wasn't really the one doing anything wrong here.

Well, except being a voyeur.

The conversation between Don and Monica burned in my ears. My stomach dropped and cool jealousy spread through me as I replayed Don moving toward her again and again.

My heart rate gradually slowed. The pain persisted in my hands and feet, but it was manageable, especially with the distractions in my mind.

The door opened with a poof of cold air.

"Honey?"

My eyes flew open. It was Monica, still in her swimsuit with the towel wrapped around her. "Oh, good," she said. "You're okay. I couldn't find you anywhere..." she closed the door and looked around the sauna. "It's not very hot in here," she said. She sat down next to me. "It's freezing out there."

"Outside?" I said.

"In the bathroom..." she squinted. "I wonder if something's broken."

She leaned against the wall and closed her eyes. "I'm just glad you're okay. Did you drink some water? Because this is very dangerous if you didn't."

Her eyes were closed and her body was relaxed, but she was unable to stop talking. "When did you come in here? I thought you didn't even like saunas. Why didn't you come back outside to the hot tub?"

"I needed some dry heat, I decided."

Monica turned and looked at me incredulously.

"So everyone is out in the hot tub, huh?" I said.

"Jerry and Cathy went to bed," Monica said, immediately and without having to think about it.

"So just... you and Don and Alicia and Mike?"

Monica kept her eyes closed.

"Mmm..."

Then they flew open, as if she only just remembered something. As if it didn't even loom at the forefront of her mind that she had just been in a very inappropriate situation with Don in the hot tub. "No! That's the thing, you missed this."

She leaned forward and put her hand on my knee. "So, Alicia and Mike and me and Don are out there, and you know, we're all pretty tanked... I think Krista was still there then, too... and we were like, going in and out because we had gotten so hot, and then I come out at some point and only Alicia and Mike are in the hot tub, and they are like, full-on making out."

Her eyes were wide.

I said nothing.

She slapped me on the arm. "Alicia," she repeated. "And *Mike*."

"I know," I said. Then I decided it was a perfect opening to tell on myself. "I, um... caught them in the act."

"What?!" Monica said. She folded her legs up underneath her body and turned to me. "*Where?*"

"So what did you do?" I asked, chugging along.

Monica looked confused. "Huh? When?"

"When you saw them," I said quietly. "What did you do?"

Monica laughed. "I dropped my glass. And then I went to clean it up and when I came back from throwing the glass out, boom, they were gone. And Don saw the whole thing, you know, unfold. Which is what I was going to tell you about -"

"And so... you just stayed out there, with Don?"

Monica gave me a look. "Well, what was I supposed to do?" she demanded. She leaned her head back and closed her eyes, an impish smile on her lips. "I had to get the scoop."

I looked at my wife. Her face was relaxed: if she was lying about anything, she didn't reveal it. In that moment I had hundreds of thoughts flit through my head: I had never really thought about whether or not Monica was a liar. Let alone if she was a good or a bad one. It had just never really crossed my mind, as stupid as it seemed now, that my wife would flirt with another man or put herself in a bad position.

Definitely not that she would cheat on me.

And now, I wondered: was Monica maybe leading some secret life I didn't know about? She was so calm, even though she had come so close to crossing a line.

And with *Don*, of all people. She always said she didn't like him, and I always believed her. She acted like she didn't like him, she rolled her eyes

and huffed about things he said, she told him off occasionally, she complained about him to me. Mostly she ignored him.

But not tonight.

It made me wonder if all of that had been an act. An act to cover up her attraction to Don.

“So?” she said, opening her eyes after a long pause. “You gonna tell me what *you* saw?”

It was my turn to be confused. “Huh?”

Monica shook her head and opened her eyes wide. “With Alicia and Mike? You said you caught them?”

“Oh,” I said, my thoughts in a shambles. I suddenly realized I didn’t have a very good story to tell, since telling would implicate me in one way or another in a pretty improper scenario.

“Uh, so...” I cleared my throat.

Well, Monica was already calculating, I could see that. She was getting a quizzical look on her face. “Where did you see them?” she said, and now there was a hint of accusation in her voice.

I rubbed my hand over my face.

“Okay,” I said. “So... I woke up on the couch, and I went to our room, and you weren’t there, and so I -”

“Wait a minute,” Monica said, slapping me gently on the arm again. “*You thought* that it was me? With Don? Is that seriously what you thought? And then you went down there and saw it was them? Is that it?”

I said nothing.

“Pig,” Monica whispered.

But she closed her eyes again, and she had a smile on her lips. “I can’t believe you,” she said.

I stared at her.

She didn’t seem mad, which was... well, weird.

Also unsettling.

“Well... hold on,” I said. “What were *you* doing that whole time?”

Monica brought her thumb to her lip and played it over the curve of her mouth. She didn’t open her eyes. She grinned mischievously. “Wouldn’t *you* like to know.”

My cock pulsed.

I had no idea what to say.

Monica shrugged. A delightful, playful little shrug, as if whatever bad thing she had done was no big deal to her. It turned my cock solid.

Monica opened one eye, and whatever she saw on my face made her smile a little. "So it's true," she said.

"What's true-" I started to say, but the final syllable drained away into a confused garble, because as I was asking the question, Monica slid her hand over my thigh and found the contours of my cock with her fingertips.

Her mouth opened slightly and she looked at me.

"It really turns you on, doesn't it?"

"What?" I said, and now my blood was rolling with the boil of confrontation, of being caught, as well as the unfamiliar excitement that had me so worked up before.

Monica shook her head. "Thinking about me with Don." Her mouth turned up at the corners when she felt my cock twitch beneath her fingertips.

"What are, I am not..." the rest of my words left my mouth in a tangled heap. I closed my jaw and told myself to shut up, because I was sounding ridiculous, even to myself.

"Don claims," Monica said, turning to face me in a kneeling position that was quite seductive, because she was perched like a porn star ready to give a blow job. "That practically every man has a secret desire to see his wife with another guy."

"That's..." is all I managed to say. Monica was gripping my cock through my swimsuit now.

Monica was smiling impishly. She started to stroke me as she continued:

"I figured that was just another thing Don was saying to try to get me into bed -"

"Does that happen a lot?" I said, in an attempt to regain control of the conversation.

I looked down at Monica's fingers briefly, at the way they were playing with my dick through my swimsuit. She curled her hand over the lip of my shorts and pulled on the elastic. I sucked in my breath, waiting for her fingers to explore my bare skin.

"Do you want it to happen a lot?" she asked.

When I looked up at her, I saw that she was watching my reaction – the reaction of my lower half – beneath my swim trunks.

“Huh,” she said.

She took my cock out, pushing my trunks away as minimally as she could while still planting my dick straight up. She started to move her hand along my shaft. My cock was dry and her hands slid over it with a soft, dry tickle, until she reached the crown. There, a pearl of precum had welled up and she rubbed her palm over it, getting her hand slippery wet, before she traveled along the length of my dick again.

“So you would actually get off on that? If I did something like this to another guy?”

My cock throbbed against her palm, and surely she felt it because she smiled. Then she closed her fingers around my shaft and leaned forward.

She wasted no time in taking the top quarter of my dick completely in her mouth. Her body was hotter than ever before, even in the heat of the sauna. Her wet tongue darted around the crown of my dick, inside the silken folds of her mouth.

Monica had always been very delightful at giving head; she somehow avoided her teeth so much as touching me. I had a thought, almost immediately after thinking about her talents: I imagined Don telling me what a great blowjob my wife gave, right after enjoying one. I felt my cock straining against Monica’s hand at the base. She murmured something with my flesh still in her mouth, and the vibrations sent me hurtling toward the crest.

“Mon,” I said, touching her hair. But she was already dropping down to the base of my cock, swallowing each inch of my dick with her wet mouth.

I was getting so close, I could scarcely believe it myself. Monica slowly moved her mouth back up the length of my cock, her hand following along the length. When she released me, it was with a wet smack, and she flicked her tongue at the bulb a few times.

“I guess you would,” she said. I knew she could feel the strain inside my dick as I tried to hang on.

“You would love to see me put my lips like this around Don’s cock...”

She was lowering her mouth again, her hand giving me a few languid strokes. When her lips covered the tip of my dick – not touching them yet, only enveloping them in her hot, moist breath – I knew it was over for me. I started to tell her I was going to come, but I was already overflowing into her mouth. She surprised me by closing her lips around the head of my cock

and letting my seed fill her mouth. I felt her tongue swirling around, sliding along the ridge between my shaft and the crown.

Then she sucked the cum from my dick, and sat back up, her finger tracing the outline of her mouth. She sucked on the end of her fingers and gave me a smile.

“You going to return the favor?” she said.

She rose up on her knees and let the towel drop away from her body – she was still in her suit. She slid her hands under the sides of the bottoms, and pulled the material down invitingly.

This wasn’t some kind of new move: Monica was an incredibly sexy woman when she wanted to be. It was just that we rarely had this kind of drunken, adventurous time any more.

“I’m *so* turned on after flirting with Don all night,” she said.

And just like that, I could feel myself coming back to life again. She slid her suit bottom down to her knees. “It’s so hard being faithful,” she said.

At the time, I didn’t weigh all the possible truth of her statement in my mind: I would later, thinking about this scene late at night. I didn’t think, consciously, about whether or not she was only teasing me, or if it was “so hard” for her to be faithful. If the slick juices between the lips of her pussy were from teasing Don or sucking my cock, or some combination of the two. I would think about all of this afterward, and it would torment me, but not that night.

That night, I just let the sultry narrative that she was telling me suck me in, and I pushed her onto her back and lifted her legs up to her ears, a lot like Mike had done with Alicia.

When I sank into her pussy, it was scorching hot and I glided through her slick juices almost too easily. Her muscles massaged me as I started to fuck her, all the images of the night, all the dirty things she and Alicia had said rising up into my thoughts and competing for space with the vision I actually had before my eyes – my sweaty, wet wife, her legs twisted in her swimsuit bottom, her lips parted and eyes locked on mine as I sawed into her pussy and she talked to me about fucking my friend.

What did she say? I can’t remember. It was all too much. Something about her pussy aching for another man’s cock, to feel him touch her in all the places I didn’t.

It wasn't long before I felt her pussy clench around me, and I was relieved, because I couldn't hold on much longer myself.

I exploded inside of her, and then I almost collapsed on top of her.

"Jesus," I said, feeling light-headed. "It's so fucking hot in here."

Monica giggled. She slapped me on the back. "Too hot!" she said. "We have to get out or we're going to die."

We stumbled out of the sauna, partly laughing and partly in a panic, because both of us were so stupidly flushed and overheated that it really did seem as if we'd do ourselves in. We shut the door. The bathroom was blessedly cool.

I crossed over to the window, almost knocking the orchid off the table again, and rolled the window open.

I looked over at Monica, who snapped her swimsuit against her hips. Her face was flushed and pink, she looked stunning.

She gave me an impish smile and came closer. "Well... that was fun," she said.

I was parched. I didn't think I could get one word out of my mouth.

Monica's interest had been caught by the window, and she stood on her tiptoes and craned her neck to peer out of it when she reached me.

I knew she could see the hot tub, and her mouth seemed to turn up a little bit when she did. But she didn't say anything. She just kissed me. "That was a really interesting... experiment," she said.

I croaked: "Oh, so you're experimenting on me," or something like that, but it came out garbled. Monica pointed at the sink. "You should really drink some water."

She was right, and I turned my head under the faucet and started gulping the ice-cold water, and only then did I realize just how dehydrated I was.

"Easy, cowboy," she said, rubbing my back. "You're gonna make yourself sick. How long were you in there, anyway?"

I stood up, and splashed cold water on my face. I stared at my reflection. I was beet-red. "Too long," I said.

Monica hugged me. "You okay?"

"Oh yeah," I said. "More than okay."

"Mmhmm," she said.

I turned around and looked at her. "So about this... thing."

She smiled. “I had no idea that was a thing,” she said. Then she put her hand on my chest. “You wouldn’t *actually* want me to *do it* would you?”

Would I?

I shook my head “no,” because I felt like that was the safest bet. What the hell did I know? I was fucked-out, hot as hell, probably still very, very drunk. If there was anything I’d learned in life (and there wasn’t much), it was that times like these were no time for commitment.

“That’s good,” Monica said. “Because...I don’t really have a thing for Don.”

I had no idea what to say to that. I had a million questions, like: “But do you have a thing for someone else?” and “Is that the only thing stopping you?” and “Are you sure, because you looked sort of like you had a thing out there?”

But Krista appeared behind us just then, said “whoop,” and covered her eyes. “Sorry,” she called.

“We were just leaving,” my wife laughed, sauntering toward the door.

“Too bad,” Krista said, her eyes moving over Monica’s body. Then she looked at me. “Oh, you better go,” she said. “You’re done for.”

I followed my wife into the hallway, thinking Krista was probably more right than she knew.

It may seem strange to you that we didn’t really discuss what happened that night. The next day, everyone felt pretty terrible and almost everyone skipped skiing and stayed in bed late. Monica and I had a flight out of Denver at ten pm. We decided to head back to the city a little earlier so we could stop at a favorite pizza place on the way back.

We both felt sick driving on the twisting roads. There wasn’t much talking; we had definitely partied too hard, like we always did. It wasn’t a cold silence; Monica had her hand on my thigh and smiled flirtatiously at me once or twice.

It just didn’t seem like the right time to bring any of it up. I think maybe I started a conversation, and I got cut off by her shouting about some mountain goats, so it seemed a little lame to re-start the conversation.

After our trip, the only time it really got brought up was peripherally, on nights when we had a lot to drink and had wild sex. Monica would talk kind of dirty, hinting at sleeping with other men.

But we never got around to talking about the specifics I wanted to dredge up, and maybe that's because I just didn't know how to bring up the question.

Hell, I didn't even know what the question was. Something about her saying that she wasn't attracted to Don, and the contrast with her behavior, was bothering me. But it was bothering me in a very peculiar, particular way: I wanted to hear more about it.

I enjoyed fantasizing that Monica was having an affair with Don. Sure, the sex with other men dirty talk was great, and it turned me on, but there was a particular, painful allure to thinking about Monica with Don in particular.

And so that's how things were, heading into the next year. It all sort of faded away by the end of summer. I still thought about it, sure, but Monica didn't really get into it while we were having sex. And then autumn rolled around, and we got some unexpected news.

Chapter 5

Cleveland is not exactly on the top of anybody's list to visit, unless they have a serious medical problem. But houses are dirt cheap and I landed a medical supply sales job there after we got married, and Monica is the sort of person who makes the best of things. She started running a dance, yoga and Pilates studio and making pretty good money at it.

Actually the city's not half-bad (particularly in summer); it has some pretty good arts, a nice market, and pretty parks. As long as you stay out of the shitty parts of town it's very livable.

But like I said, it's not a real destination for anyone. In fact, we've never had a single visitor.

Which is why I found myself staring out of my large back windows, surveying the pretty yard and the crooked, climbable linden tree that shaded half of it in summer and streaked the sky in interesting black-brown and white lines all winter, unable to understand what Don was saying to me on the phone.

"You're...?" I said helplessly.

Don was getting annoyed. He'd said whatever it was he was saying twenty times, and I still couldn't figure it out. Not only that, I couldn't figure out why Don was even calling me, or where he'd gotten my number from. We were the kind of "friends" who saw each other once a year, tops, and didn't call to chat like women about anything in the interim.

"Co-ming-to-Cleve-land-where-do-I-stay?" Don shouted, using a slow, sarcastic intonation. "Jesus! You deaf or something, Orie?"

I said nothing, just squinted at my tree.

"Gettin' old," Don said. "So how about it? I'll be there in a week."

"Why?" was all I could think of to say.

"Business shit. You want to go out to dinner or something? Listen, you plan it for us, I'll send you the dates. Pick a good place, okay?"

"Uh, sure.. okay."

"Don't sound so excited, man."

"No, I'm excited. I just... you're the last person I expected to call."

"Yeah, well, I wasn't exactly – hey!" Don placed a hand over the microphone and yelled something at someone. It sounded like a job site,

with a lot of clanging in the background. I pondered that I didn't even really know what it was that Don *did* – he had a business but he was also a venture capitalist or something.

My stomach felt cold as I sat there waiting for him.

Don. Coming to Cleveland. Dinner.

I pictured my wife, all dressed up in some kind of cocktail dress, sitting across from Don. Rolling her eyes at everything he said, but secretly running her foot up his pant leg...

"Oren, buddy. Gotta go," Don yelled into the phone. "I'll send you the dates."

And then he was gone.

By the time Monica came home from her run, I was pretty worked up.

It was an unusually warm day, so when she came through the door, her face was red and strands of her blonde hair had turned dark with sweat and clung to her damp skin, curving along her neck or her cheek.

"Whoa," she said, wiping her forehead. "It's hot as hell out there."

She was busy recording her workout into her phone, so she didn't really look at me. She went past me to get a glass of water. "Do you feel like brunch?" she said, as she filled up the glass.

She was coming back my way. I could tell because I smelled the sweet scent of her sweat, felt the radiating heat of her body as she neared.

I turned around and slid my arm around her waist. I pulled her close to me.

I love the smell of Monica's sweat. She does not feel the same way about me, so she has a hard time believing it. She squirmed away from me, crinkling her nose. "Honey," she said. "I'm totally sweaty. You're going to get your shirt all wet."

I didn't let her get away. I pulled her gently to me and buried my face in her damp neck. I flicked my tongue at her skin. It was salty and warm.

Monica relented, and then she moved her thigh against my body. "Hmm," she said. "Somebody's randy this morning... what's gotten into you?"

We had already had sex that morning: a sort of uneventful, late-morning, Sunday sex, before we got out bed.

And I knew what had gotten into me, but I decided to keep that part to myself.

“Nothing,” I said innocently. I was just... you know... hoping for some more Monica.”

Monica raised an eyebrow. “Okay, but let me take a shower.”

I had her by the hips, and I pulled her closer to me. “I sort of like the taste of you.”

“Salty?”

I sucked on her neck.

“Oh God, Oren,” Monica giggled. “Let me go rinse off!”

But now I really didn’t want to wait. I had spent the ten minutes between Don’s call and her return allowing my mind to picture her stripping her clothes off for Don, letting him slip his hands all over her body, under her tight running pants, into the folds of her pussy.

I maneuvered her back into the kitchen, where a small island took up most of the cooking space. It was very, very high, and there was no way I was actually going to lift her onto it.

But Monica helped, by jumping at the same time I made my move.

I pulled on her sports bra, and it peeled away from her sweaty skin to emit a puff of sweet-smelling moisture. I licked her left nipple, which was already hard, and was treated to the taste of her sweat on her bright pink skin. I bit gently into it.

Monica’s hands wandered down to my cock, and squeezed me when she found my cock hard and ready. “Okay, seriously,” she said. “What’s gotten into you?”

I didn’t let her finish her sentence. I covered her mouth with mine and explored it with my tongue: the salty edges of her lips, the sweet hot center of her mouth, her tongue darting with surprise and then relenting.

I rolled her nipples beneath my thumbs and savored the heavy, round shape of her breasts in my palm. As her body ignited and she responded to me, the scent of her sweaty skin grew stronger and she pushed against me.

It was then that the logistics of our situation came into play: there was no way to have sex on this high countertop.

I pulled Monica toward me and she wrapped her legs around my waist. She was so strong that it was a bit like one of those backpacks: all her weight was on my hips and I moved her easily from the tabletop. She laughed and ran her fingers through my hair. “I was wondering what your plan was with that,” she said.

I carried her into the living room and we bumped into the couch. Monica dropped her feet and surveyed our situation. We were still kissing, biting at each other's lips. I had the images of her and Don in the hot tub, mingled with Mike and Alicia, bubbling in my mind, and I felt like I could come at the drop of a hat.

It was Monica who smiled and turned around, leaning against the back of the couch. She swept her hands down to her leggings and pulled them until her ass was bare and the leggings framed it. She kept her hands hooked in her pants and threw her ponytail as she looked back at me.

The scent of her pussy was mingled with her sweat. Monica placed her hands on her ass and slid a finger between her legs, drawing her pussy juices up and over her puckered hole.

I stared at her fingers and her ass. It was a pretty racy move for a Sunday morning.

She pushed her ass back against me, and her fingers sought my cock. In seconds I was sinking into her hot flesh. The walls of her pussy pressed down on my dick, not like the usual missionary sex we seemed to have so often. The sensation made me dizzily aroused, and my legs trembled with the effort of crouching as I needed to and trying not to come too soon.

I clutched Monica's round bottom with one hand and pulled on her pony-tail with the other. I had a sudden urge to dominate her, to fill her full of cum, and it was almost bestial.

She seemed to like the idea. She ground her ass against me, and the tone of our sex turned suddenly very hard. I rammed inside of her, burying my cock deep in her pussy, enjoying the guttural mewl that came from her open mouth each time the base of my cock kissed her moist pussy-lips.

Monica's body shuddered as she came, and I felt her pussy turn to liquid honey. This sent me over the edge, and I yelled as I thrust into her one last time.

It was an almost violent turn to what had begun as kind of sweet lovemaking. It's the sort of thing that happens all the time, but for some reason there was a strange undertone to it. I was left, my cock deflating and flopping out of her pussy, wondering what Monica had been thinking that whole time. Where her mind was, if mine was on her fucking another man.

She wiped her face and leaned back. "Whoa," she commented. "I didn't even take my shoes off."

Then she laughed, turned to kiss me, and hopped up the stairs to take a shower. “Let’s go to brunch!” she called down from the top steps.

I stood in the living room, my cock in my hand, the scent of Monica everywhere in the room, wondering about myself.

We went to brunch.

I waited a good half-hour, until we’d had a mimosa and our food was brought to the table, to bring up Don. For some reason, I wanted some distance between the sexual episode that had gotten... well, sort of dark and weird, and mentioning him.

I watched Monica, with her impeccable manners, carefully cutting her healthy, spinach omelet into tiny pieces – because she was always a health nut unless it was a very special occasion – before I said, very casually:

“Oh, guess who I talked to today?”

Monica put a small piece of omelet in her mouth and chewed. She squinted at the ceiling and really made a performance out of pretending like she was thinking about it really hard. “Um, Barbara Bush,” she said finally. Then she laughed and brought her mimosa to her mouth. “No, who?”

“Where did Barbara Bush come from?” I said. I really wanted it to seem like the news about Don’s visit was not a piece of information burning through my chest, something I was dying to tell her so I could see how she reacted.

Monica shrugged and grinned. She let her very sexy, very hearty laugh bubble up from her throat again. “I dunno,” she said. “Just thinking about Barbara Bush for some reason.”

“She hasn’t called in a while,” I quipped.

Monica grinned and her eyes twinkled. She liked my joke. She pointed a finger at me as she brought a glass of water to her mouth. “Exactly.”

She took a sip and set it down, then folded her hands in her lap and looked at me expectantly.

I waited. It was hard, and my chest had that cold, excited feeling from back in Aspen, but I waited.

“So?” she said.

“So...?” I said, as if I’d totally forgotten what we were talking about.

“Who’d you talk to today?” she asked.

“Oh, yeah,” I said. I made myself take a breath. “It’s weird. Don called me. He’s coming to Cleveland in like two weeks.”

I watched her, my eyes taking in every movement of her face, her arms, her fingers.

Her eyes crinkled up, and her mouth fell open slightly. “Don... Don and Alicia, Don?” she said. She looked surprised.

But was it genuine surprise? Or fake?

“Uh-huh.”

She crinkled her nose, looked down at her napkin on her lap, straightened it out and smoothed it.

Then she seemed to be thinking about something.

She looked up at me, and she got a knowing sort of look on her face for a nanosecond.

“That’s sort of boring,” she commented. “I was really hoping for Barbara Bush.”

We were silent. I realized I had no idea if her reaction was normal or not. What did I have to compare to it? Was she actually “bored” by the idea of Don coming, or was she just saying that? Was “that’s boring,” something she would have said about anyone else? Or was it just the continuation of the joke about Barbara Bush? It seemed so harsh, not like something Monica would say at all. Was she saying it to make it *seem* like she thought Don was boring, when in reality she was excited about it? What would I feel, if I put my hand to her heart now: a fluttering? A faster beat?

“What the hell is he coming to Cleveland for?” she said, when the silence dragged on. She picked up her fork and started cutting her omelet with it.

This was not a very Monica-like action. She was a fork-and-knife eater, like she’d been trained at some British boarding school. It had been part of something she had to do when she was a cheerleader, so they didn’t embarrass themselves at fancy dinners.

“I, uh... I don’t know. You know Don. He’s always so busy on the phone.”

Monica did not respond to this.

“He wants to go to dinner,” I said.

Monica put a piece of omelet in her mouth. She chewed thoughtfully again, looking out the window.

I had a sea of emotions clashing around inside of me.

“We could go to that -” Monica started to say, but she cut herself off by pointing a fork at the parking lot. “Holy moly,” she said. “That guy just smashed into the back of that lady’s car.”

I looked out the window. An irate woman was climbing out of her car, heading with fire and fury toward the driver of the truck, who had indeed backed right into her car and totaled the rear left of the vehicle.

That was the end, lamentably, of any talk about Don.

Otherwise, I’d look way too interested in the topic.

And then, before I knew it, it was the day Don was coming to Cleveland. And we were all going out.

Chapter 6

I was surprised to see Monica's car in the driveway when I got home: I had left work really early, because of a late-afternoon meeting that I thought it was best to avoid. But Monica had a lot of classes scheduled on Wednesday afternoons and evenings, and she had to be half-dead from the flu to miss them. She liked the workout. Monica was not a sit-around and eat bon-bons kind of girl.

I eyed her car suspiciously. I felt like she had even told me she was planning to teach her five-o'clock yoga, which would get her home at 6:30. I remembered this because it was cutting it pretty close.

Now she was here at 4:00 in the afternoon.

"Mon?" I said, when I opened the door.

There was no answer, but the reason was pretty evident. Our house was an old one, beautiful and magnificently refurbished, but deep down inside, old. The pipes made a lot of noise when they were used, and even if someone was up on the third floor taking a shower, you knew it.

And that's what Monica was doing.

I shut the door behind me and set my keys on the table.

The house is a big, rambling, one, with lots of interesting secret passages for the one or two servants the first family to own it might have had. There were actually four usable floors: at the very top of the house was a sloped attic-like area that had been finished off. Below that, on the third floor, were two rooms that we never used and rarely saw, joined by a bathroom with white-checked tile, a huge old bathtub, and a glass-enclosed shower.

It wasn't all that weird that Monica was taking a shower up there. She liked the checked tiles, she liked the big window that looked out onto the yard. She often said the bathroom made her feel like she was "in the thirties or something."

I took my coat off and walked up the stairs.

It was also pretty hard to sneak around in our house, even though the stairs had been re-done at some point. But, by walking on the outside edges of the stairs, you could make a good show of it.

I'm not sure why I decided to creep up there. Maybe I was just playing out my little fantasy, whatever it was. I had been turning Monica and Don over and over in my mind until I was a little crazy.

I reached the third floor, where it was warm and humid and fruit scented, an indication that Monica had been in that shower for quite a while. And that she had left one of the doors open a crack, which was a classic Monica move. No doubt she also had not turned on the fan in the bathroom, or cracked a window. She didn't turn on the small heaters in the winter either. She had grown up in Arizona and Colorado and did not believe that mildew even existed.

The door to the small hallway was closed, which meant that one of the doors leading to the bedrooms was open. I bet on the one on the left, because Monica liked to keep some of her extra clothes up there, and I crept that way, along the wall like a cat, trying not to make the floor creak.

I was really taking my life into my hands by doing this: Monica was not only super-fit, she was a karate black belt and a self-defense guru. If she heard the floor creak she was just as likely to come out and smash my head as she was to ask if I was there. The girl had a gun, and it was locked away somewhere, but she really wasn't messing around with home invasion.

I entered the east-side room.

A black dress, best described as a gathering of material that seemed filled with holes and not especially recognizable, was laid out on the bed. I didn't pay much attention to it at the time, because I was busy creeping, and let's face it, black dresses are black dresses until they're on.

I looked through the door, which was open about four inches, until I adjusted where I was so that I could see the mirror, and the reflection across from it, and a sliver of Monica in the shower. Because of the angle of the mirror and the medicine cabinet, I could only see a small sliver of her at a time.

I lingered on the sliver of her rounded bottom, water beaded on her skin, still slightly tanned from the summer. Her toned arm, the firm slope of her waist.

Then I moved to the left so that I could get a view of the front of her. Maybe a peek of her rosy nipples, her white-blond landing strip, the thin red line of her gash.

My eyes went wide as I took in what I saw, and I moved, adjusting the frame of my view, as though it would change the scene. And then I

settled on the best view I could get: a two-inch sliver that contained a part of her lower lip, her mouth open and her head tilted a little. A slice of her right arm, held up against the tiles of the wall. Her nipple, bouncing slightly as her body moved, the length of her forearm, holding the showerhead, and the glint of silver between her legs.

She was breathing heavily: I could see it in her chest and the way her mouth moved. She looked down at the showerhead, and I lost sight of her mouth. I moved to get a better view, but it was just a montage of skin-filled images, all of them adding up to this: my wife was masturbating in the shower.

She moaned, and then she threw her head back, and then her mouth began to move as she said something I couldn't hear. But a rapid succession of words, like she was talking to someone. And then she let out a guttural groan as she came.

She leaned forward and put her forehead on the tiles, panting.

I backed away.

My cock was hard, my brain was filling up with thoughts of Don and Monica faster than I could shake a stick at any of them. I forgot to be quiet and sneaky, the floor creaked as I stepped back into the hall.

My heart stopped in my chest, but only for a moment. Then I remembered that I lived there, and that this was *my* wife.

"Mon?" I called out, and started toward the door to the hallway as though I'd been headed there all along. The door was locked. I jiggled the handle and turned toward the bedroom, and walked in from that side.

Monica had hung the shower head back up on its cradle and was standing, facing away from the spray of water, her head tipped back as though she were rinsing shampoo from her hair. "Jesus," she said calmly. "I didn't hear you until you were all the way up here. You scared me."

Her cheeks were flushed.

"What are you doing home so early?" she said.

"What are *you* doing home so early?" I countered. I started unbuttoning my shirt. I had an idea, at that point, to get into the shower with her, see how she reacted to me finding her pussy slippery and wet with excitement. Would she squirm away from me? Or pretend that she wasn't sore? Or maybe she was just a crazily horny woman, at the thought of seeing Don, that she'd be into it. Maybe she'd reject me. I had no idea, but any of these possibilities were strangely alluring in their own way.

“I decided I’d be pushing it to try and get here and get changed,” she said. “And then I realized I didn’t really have a good dress for Bleu. So I went shopping, but I found the dress I liked in, like, five minutes. So here I am.”

Bleu was the restaurant we’d decided on, and as you might be able to tell from the name, it was fancy-pants as fuck.

I peeled off my clothes and opened the door. To be fair, Monica’s whole explanation was pitch-perfect and frankly a little disappointing, but she couldn’t hide the fact that she’d been masturbating.

She looked at me like I was insane when I stepped into the shower. “What are you doing?” she asked.

I slid my hands onto her waist, along her ribs, which made her laugh, and then cupped a breast in my hand. “I don’t know,” I said. “You’re here, I’m here, it’s the afternoon, we have a lot of time...” I lowered my head to run my tongue around her left nipple, which hardened delightfully between my lips. I slid my other hand down to the silky wet hair of her landing strip, using it to guide me to her gash.

The outside lips of her pussy were rubbery-wet, but I delved further to find the silky, slippery wetness of her core. I felt her body ripple when I brushed over her clit, and she jumped slightly.

“Hmm,” I said. I brought my fingers up and rubbed them together, then tasted them. Monica watched me, and it’s hard to say what the look on her face was.

I returned my hand to her pussy, and she jumped a little again as I explored her wet cunt.

“What have you been up to?” I said.

“Oh, you know,” Monica said casually. “I had Jack the cabana boy over this afternoon. You just missed him.”

I looked her in the eye, and my cock throbbed against her leg. She gave me another one of her impish grins, and I pushed her back against the tiled wall.

Then she laughed. “Okay, listen, let’s not do this here. I feel like one of us is going to go through the glass.”

She was right, of course. The shower was made of glass on three sides and not designed for shower sex by anyone’s stretch of the imagination.

But I was feeling... I don’t know. Testy. I didn’t let her move away, but rather, reached up for the showerhead and pulled it from its cradle. “I

have another idea,” I said.

I lowered the shower head, watching Monica’s face carefully. She bit her lip, but that was all: she wasn’t going to reveal anything about what she’d just been up to, and she also didn’t seem to suspect that I knew anything about it.

I turned the shower head on massage with my fingers, and guided the nozzle down the length of her body. Monica seemed almost frozen: I couldn’t tell if she was unsure of what to do, unsure if I had been spying on her, or what. But she let me push her legs open, pull her lips apart with the fingers of my left hand, and get her clit exposed and ready for the pulse of the shower head. All she did was look at me, almost like she was daring me to do it.

I guided the shower head toward her pussy, and she dropped her hand to the handle and pushed it back slightly. “Too close,” she whispered. She moved my hand about three inches away, and then turned my wrist so that the stream of water sprayed toward her clit.

I felt her body ripple again, and her eyes went moist and dark with pleasure before her eyelids drooped over them. Her mouth parted, and a puff of air escaped her lips. “There,” she whispered.

I stared at my wife as she let the pulse of the water pleasure her again. It was obviously intense against her already-stimulated clit, but she seemed to delight in it. We looked at each other as she began to move her hips, and her breath grew more ragged.

When she finally began to go over the edge of her orgasm, she reached for my cock and squeezed it in her hand. When she came, she gasped, and let go of the handle of the shower. The water sprayed around as the shower head went in circles, and she must have felt the way my cock pulsed just as wildly in her hand.

The sprayer came to rest in a corner of the shower, swaying back and forth as the pulse of water repelled it from the opposite glass wall.

Monica gave me a devilish look, used her elbow to turn off the water, and slid down the front of me to her knees. She trailed her hands halfway down my chest and grinned before she took my cock into her mouth.

I shuddered, because by then I knew it wouldn’t take much for me to boil over. I wanted it to last as long as it possibly could, but trying to direct my thoughts away from everything I’d just seen and imagined proved impossible. Monica had only to slide her hot mouth along the length of my

shaft a few times and I leaned forward against the tile. I told her I was going to come and she lowered a hand to squeeze my balls. She held me in her mouth as my seed gushed into her throat.

Monica pulled my cock from her mouth with one hand, licking my shaft as she went. Then she rose up to her feet, sliding, wet and beautiful, between me and the tile wall. She smiled.

Then she turned the water on again, and ran the shower head over her body, before she handed it to me (I was standing there, stunned, like a bit of an idiot), and popped the door open.

I hung the shower head back up and turned around to watch her as she toweled herself off with a thick blue towel.

“What got into *you*?” I asked, finally.

“Me?” Monica said. “You started it.”

I had nothing to say to that. So I said nothing. I turned back around and faced the shower head as Monica sauntered out of the room.

“Let’s get dressed up and go have cocktails ahead of time, like fancy people,” Monica called out.

Bleu was a really, really, really, *really* expensive restaurant. Notoriously so, in fact. I fully expected to have to drop half a grand, if not more, on dinner, which I have to say was not pleasing to me in the least.

But I didn’t want to have to tell Don I couldn’t afford to eat there.

Also, I was secretly hoping he would magnanimously offer to pay the bill, just to show how much money he had.

The only thing I hoped to avoid was somehow ending up insisting on paying the bill myself and ending up dropping two grand that night.

I confided all this to Monica over our cocktails at a bar we’d never heard of or been to, down the street from Bleu, where very young people were serving us drinks with the same frown that Starbuck’s baristas used.

Monica laughed, and then she set her drink down. Her face became very sultry and very serious. She ran a finger along the rim of her martini glass and sucked on a bit of the vodka.

Her face was already flushed from the half martini. She closed her lips around her finger.

“I guarantee you,” she purred. “That Don will end up paying for dinner.”

A very sexual sensation lurched around inside of me. After all, what did it all mean? Who could tell? But my wife meant something by it, and that something made me wild with lust.

I took a sip of my martini and Monica smiled. She seemed very pleased with herself.

The alcohol I had consumed loosened my lips a little. "Oh, really," I said. "I'm beginning to suspect there's more to you and this Don character than meets the eye."

Monica smiled. She brought her martini glass to her mouth and cocked her head before taking a sip.

"Whatever do you mean?" she asked me. She batted her eyelashes for extra effect.

I wondered if Monica knew she was pushing my buttons. How she knew it, how she had figured out to do it in such a way that I was left liquefied on the inside.

"Oh, nothing," I said. "You just seem very dressed up for someone who, quote, doesn't really have a thing for Don."

Monica smiled over the lip of her martini glass.

And said nothing.

"We better go," I said.

Don stood up to greet us. He was clad in a very expensive suit and he looked good in it. He made straight for Monica first, not hiding the way his eyes traveled all over her. He took both her hands and whistled. "Damn girl," he said. "You look good."

Monica cocked her head to the side and smiled a pursed-lipped smile. "Thanks," she said. She swept her eyes around us, as though she were scoping the place out. "Where's Alicia?" she asked.

"Not here," Don declared jovially, and I wasn't quite sure what to make of his tone.

Monica shot me a look, and I honestly didn't know what to make of it. She almost looked like she had "told me so," but I couldn't recollect her having told me anything.

I pulled her chair out for her, since I had no idea what else to do. I *did* find Alicia's absence a little unsettling.

But also a little exciting. It was as if we had moved a little closer to the fire.

Monica sat down and looked around the room with critical eyes. “Swanky,” she whispered to me.

I sat down as well, but Don, curiously, remained standing. It took me a moment to figure out that he had seen someone he knew. He moved around the chair and started in the other direction, arms extended.

Monica and I turned around in our seats together, and saw a very tall, very good-looking black man smiling broadly and heading toward Don.

They did that whole alpha-male back clapping thing, and then Don turned toward us, pulling the guy along.

I stood up, and Monica sat there, a weird expression on her face.

I started to get the feeling I’d seen the guy before somewhere.

“These are my friends, Monica and Oren, they’re old friends,” Don said, waving his hand in front of us like we were puppets in a show.

The black man extended his hand. Don didn’t introduce him, and the guy had a smile on his face like he didn’t need to be introduced.

He took Monica’s hand delicately, and lowered his huge frame to kiss the back of it.

“Monica here was actually a cheerleader for the Nuggets in 2002,” Don said, and I started to get an uneasy feeling of recognition in my stomach. “You were still -”

“Oh, I know Monica,” the guy said. His voice was smooth and deep, his grin even bigger.

I looked at Monica. She had taken her hand back and was rubbing her nose lightly with the length of her middle finger. It was her single gesture of nervousness. “Good to see you again, Ty.”

Don looked at me, and then he looked at each one of us, his arrogant face beaming. “No shit,” he said.

“Ty” - who I was now realizing was Tyler Smith, a decent basketball midlister who had once played (it would seem) for the terrible Nuggets – was still smiling at Monica.

Then, he looked up and around the restaurant. “Well, listen folks, I gotta go meet my party. Y’all have a nice dinner.”

And just like that, he was gone.

Don sat down, and I followed suit.

And Monica took her intricately arranged white napkin, shook it out next to her, and placed it primly on her lap. She said nothing, but her cheeks were a light pink.

Ty was lowering himself into a chair on the other side of the restaurant, where a lot of big black guys, red-faced white men, and very glittery, pretty girls were seated.

A waiter arrived with red wine, which Monica started drinking before ours was even poured.

“How do you know Ty?” she said to Don, almost breathlessly, when the waiter said he’d return to take our order.

Don looked back at Ty’s table, turning his whole body around to do it. “I’ve got my hands in a lot of cookie jars,” he said, turning back.

And then Don and my wife looked at each other over the table, and for a moment the air seemed to simmer.

“You?” Don said.

Monica glared at him.

Don smiled and brought his wine glass to his lips. “Oh that’s right, cheerleading.”

And then he smiled.

The waiter, gratefully, came back to take our order. I rattled off something, not entirely sure what it was, and Monica gave her order dryly, still glaring in Don’s general direction.

The waiter left, and Don leaned back in his chair. I could see he was up to something – and with Don, that usually means stirring up shit – so I decided to intervene.

“Why is it Alicia isn’t here?” I said. “She didn’t want to come to beautiful Cleveland?”

Don tapped his wine glass lightly. He was still looking at Monica, a sort of smirk forming under his set mouth. “Nah, man, she didn’t,” he said. He only turned his eyes toward me at the last minute. “You know, it actually isn’t as bad as I thought it would be. The city, I mean.”

“And... what are you here for, exactly?” Monica said. She brought her wine to her lips. She seemed to be recovering from whatever it was that had unsettled her about running into Ty Smith.

A bit of history on this: most people are shocked to all hell to find out that I married a Nuggets cheerleader. The next thing they immediately wonder is if my wife was sleeping with the guys on the team. It’s something I always wanted to know, and it’s also something I finally asked Monica. Her response had been to roll her eyes and explain how the idea that all the cheerleaders were having some great time and having sex with all the

players was as ridiculous as the male fantasy that women had pillow fights in their underwear at slumber parties. Cheerleading, she assured me, was a lot of work for too little pay and had been mostly an adventure in vanity that she had gotten tired of quickly and quit because after paying for all the make-up, uniforms, tanning beds, waxing, and hair upkeep, she didn't make enough money to pay her way through university, and it also took up way too much of her time. Monica, at the end of the day, is all business: if she isn't making good money she doesn't fuck with it for long.

So her story had seemed very credible.

Now, though, I was having my doubts.

But back to dinner: Don smiled suggestively. "Oh, just some business ventures. It probably could have been handled over the phone."

He was looking at Monica when he added: "But I wanted to see you."

At the last moment he took me in with his eyes, as if to pluralize the "you" for the sake of propriety. But the implication was clear: he had wanted to see "you," singular, "you, *Monica*."

I gulped my wine, privately wondering what my tolerance level for this sort of thing was. It was turning me on, but it was pissing me off as well.

Monica made a face and brought her wine to her lips. She was draining it pretty fast, especially for her, and especially since she'd had a martini already. "How lovely," she said.

Don was undeterred, and if Monica's tone put him out, he didn't show it. I would, in fact, say that Monica's iciness had the opposite effect on him. He seemed intrigued, ignited by the challenge. And that's when I had a sinking (and delightful) thought: what if Monica was only being cold to Don because she knew it enticed him more?

I looked at my wife, trying to get a read for what she was up to.

Don leaned forward on his elbows and folded one fist into his other hand. "So," he said, a gleam in his eye. "Dish the dirt, Monica. What was it like being a hot, blonde cheerleader with all those big, tall black athletes around all the time?"

This made my cock hard. It settled right in my groin and my limbs started tingling. I probably should have told Don to knock it off, but the truth was, I sort of wanted to watch the two of them interact. I wanted to see what Monica had to say.

My wife's mouth turned into a very mysterious smile. "Wouldn't you like to know," she said.

Don didn't relent. "Yes. Very much so. Tell the truth. How well do you know Ty over there?"

Monica's right hand was on the table, and I saw her pointer finger tap. Once, twice. A little tick while she thought about her answer. She leaned slightly in my direction, to look at Tyler over Don's shoulder.

"Oh," she said. "Pretty well."

Don grinned. "You sleep with him?"

The conversation was way, way out of line. Really. I knew that. It was my turn to interject, tell Don to shut up.

But Monica could hold her own with Don.

And I was caught up in this like I was watching TV. Erotic TV.

"I don't kiss and tell, Don. You know that by now."

Monica's face was unreadable. She smiled, a challenging, bantering kind of smile, and took another sip of wine.

Don grinned at Monica. He liked her answer, and he didn't have a comeback. Not just yet. He looked over at me, and I had to work hard not to look away. I shrugged.

"I'll bet she did," he said, to no one in particular. Then he grinned at Monica, who stared him down cheerfully. "I bet you did," he said.

Monica shrugged, as though she didn't care. Then she smoothed her napkin again, as if to say: we'd just have to wonder.

It was a little uncomfortable sitting there for a moment, while Don grinned and thought about my wife fucking Tyler Smith, and I did the same without the same grin on my face. Monica leaned on her elbow and finished her glass of wine. Pointedly.

Then, thank you sweet Jesus: our food arrived.

The evening wore on, as course after course came to our table. We started drinking quite a bit of wine, and this loosened up everyone's tongue. Halfway through the meal, we were back in jovial spirits; Monica started talking about her studio, Don appeared interested in what I was saying about my job, we grumbled about politicians together and then talked about movies. The edge that had been present at the beginning of the dinner started to wear off, which had its disappointing aspects but mostly made me feel relieved.

When we were finished, Don recommended that we go get a digestif in the adjoining bar, a railway-car themed hole in the wall that was only accessible through the restaurant. Monica leaned on one arm and said, sleepily, “Aw, it’s getting late. I have a class in the morning.”

It was me who smiled. “There is no way you’re making that class.” Monica was four or five glasses in on the wine.

But I knew as well as she did that she could have made it to class still; she was a real trooper and never let a hangover hold her back from a workout. She, in fact, professed to feel better after one.

So I was surprised when she looked at me for a moment, chewing on something in her mind, and then said: “Yeah. You’re right.” She took out her phone and started sending a text message. “Just let me get a sub.”

Don rubbed his hands together with glee. “This’ll be just like old times,” he said to me.

I hoped not. Don was a college buddy, and I was too old to engage in “old times” even if I had really wanted to. But now that I had made the suggestion, and Monica was agreeing to stay out, I was starting to regret it. What was I thinking? What had prompted me to drag things out?

Did I really want to see how far Monica would take her “thing” (whatever it was) with Don?

My stomach started to feel cool as Monica typed and Don smiled and all the pieces started to fall into place for a long evening out, with more chances for Monica to flirt icily with Don and egg him on. I started to move my hand toward Monica’s leg, to un-do it all, when she looked up from her phone.

“Okay,” she said. “Teresa’s got all my morning classes for me.” She looked at me. “Call in tomorrow. We’ll take the day off.”

“Sure,” I said numbly.

Don slammed what was left of his wine – the remnants of a second bottle we had split after we realized that we were going to be boozing it up and stopped ordering by the glass. “Let’s do this thing!” he said.

And so, theatrically, we got up and went into the Trolley Car, arms linked together.

I was so drunk I didn’t really notice that Don had taken Monica’s arm until we were too wide as a threesome to fit through the door.

I let her go ahead with him, and watched them as they moved ahead of me, a nice-looking couple – arms entwined.

We took a seat at the bar with Monica between us. She laughed a lot and asked Don for advice about her drink. Then she turned to me and gave me a look, and a wink, and stroked my arm. “This is going to be fun,” she said.

About five minutes went by, and we had just started in on our drinks, when the party from Ty Smith’s table – about half of them, anyway – came into the bar. They passed us at the bar and Ty put his hands on Monica’s chair. His thick forearm came between me and my wife, almost as though he thought Don and Monica were the couple. He turned to Don. “Hey y’all still here? You wanna join our party?”

A very pretty, tall black woman, with extremely ethnic features and a wild afro that made her seem a foot taller than she was, raised a hand and waved at us backwards. “I told you I gotta go, I have work in the morning, unlike the rest of you lazy brothers.” And she jingled and jangled away in her sexy orange dress and banging bracelets, taking one of the pouty-lipped girls with her.

“Mon?” Ty said, looking at my wife. “Come on over. Catch me up.”

My heart felt like someone had stabbed through it with an ice pick. Don’s eyes were greedily taking in the scene and he looked at me with interest.

Monica gave me a glance, and I didn’t make any motion or gesture of objection.

“It’ll be fun,” Don said, a little hint of evil in his voice. He slapped me on the arm, reaching across Monica and the ebony forearm of Ty Smith to do it.

Monica shrugged. “Oh hell, let’s go.” She looked at me, and grinned. “These guys know how to party.”

And before I could think of anything to do, or say, or even collect my thoughts about what I wanted to do or say, Monica was sliding out of the bar chair. She was a little unsteady, and the back of her skirt caught on the material of the chair and hiked up along her thigh, revealing a long, delicious stretch of her leg. I glanced quickly at Ty and saw, to my perverse delight, that he was taking it all in.

He was a smooth operator, and quickly moved his eyes away when Monica looked up and wobbled out from behind the chair.

I swiveled, and stood up to follow them.

Tyler Smith – *Tyler Smith* – in his enormous and expensive suit, turned in front of me, following right behind my wife. I couldn't be sure, because the room was so crowded, but it looked as though he brought his hands up to Monica's shoulders to steer her through the crowd.

Which turned me on. I'll admit it.

By the time we reached the half-circle booth where only three people were squeezed in, he had stopped touching Monica (supposing he had been at all), and stepped aside, indicating that I should squeeze into the booth. Monica positioned herself so that it was pretty clear she wanted to squeeze in after me.

I had no choice, then, but to slide along the booth inward ever more, to rub shoulders with a very attractive blonde who looked no more than twenty. She looked at me and smiled, the overly friendly, overly sexual smile of a twenty-year old who knows she's attractive and considers everyone a mark until she knows they aren't famous or rich.

"Oh hi there," she said to me. "I'm Caristala."

I blinked slowly at the sheer number of syllables in her confusing name. "Crista..la?" I asked.

"Caristala," she repeated, still smiling warmly.

"Call her Carrie, man," a gangly black man in sunglasses said to me, leaning over. "Girl, your name's too fucked-up for anyone to remember it."

"Carrie" giggled and played with her straw. The black guy gave me one of those chin-nods, which was a gesture I didn't know how to return, and not wanting to look like some idiot cracker, I didn't. I stuck my hand out to him as Monica pressed against me tightly.

"Oren," I said.

"Hey man," the guy said, and I guess he was also famous, because he didn't bother introducing himself. "Oh hey, look at this shit, look who it is."

He was talking to my wife, who was adjusting her dress, which had pulled down dangerously low on her bosom in all the squeezing. "Hey James," she said. "Can't believe you remember me."

"I'll be damned. This your man?" He was yelling now, looking over Carrie at me.

His look was chilled and almost frightening.

And then he winked.

The next hour or so is a blur in my memory. It consisted of my wife talking excitedly to Tyler, and then to James, and Carrie talking to me until I told her what I did for a living. Don was chatty with everyone, and we were all getting very drunk. But it seemed like I caught my wife looking over at Don almost every time I looked in her direction.

And Don, while he may have been chatting with some other girl who never introduced herself and just appeared, lanky and pouty-faced and almost too young to be there – it was clear that his eyes were on Monica. Watching her like a hawk.

A possessive hawk.

At least that's how I saw it.

Monica seemed to be enjoying herself. She was enjoying teasing me, teasing Don, teasing Don by teasing me – or was it the other way around?

And then, quite suddenly, as I sat there mulling everything over in a very sour state of mind, with a partial erection, wondering what sort of man I was... everyone started scooting out of the booth.

I looked up.

"Come on," Monica said.

I followed, and we made our way down some stairs in the back and out a back door.

"Man," Tyler complained, coming to a halt. The skinny girl with no name ran into him and laughed. Tyler walked forward, bringing his phone to his ear. "How you gonna take a limo to the wrong place? Jay, man, where the fuck are you...?"

He walked into the parking lot.

"Mon," I said, as we all gathered around on the small cement balcony, waiting for... whatever. Don produced a joint from somewhere, and the smell of weed filled the air. Carrie and James started an argument about her smoking a cigarette.

"What are we doing?" I whispered.

"Going to a party," Don said, to my right.

Monica leaned over the railing and looked at Don, a twinkle in her eye. "Yeah."

I frowned. "I dunno," I said.

"Oh come on," Monica said. She rubbed her shoulders in the cold. "You can't drive anyway, let's just go with them and take a cab from

wherever. How many times do you think you'll have the chance to party with NBA players?"

"Former," I said grimly. "Former NBA players." I could at least make sure the terminology was correct.

"Oh come on," she said, and she reached across me for the joint Don was smoking idly, with a movement as natural as though she did it every day. "We're already going to be paying for this tomorrow. Let's live a little."

I gave her a look, and Don smiled. She handed the joint to me and blew smoke across my lips. "Come on," she said sexily. "It'll be fun, I promise."

She flitted her fingers over my cock before she leaned back.

"Ladies!" Ty called from the open door of the limo. "Y'all in or out?"

Monica did not look to me for an answer. She walked straight toward the open door and hopped in.

So what could I do, but follow?

Chapter 7

I don't know how it happened, but when we got into the limo (which had eventually made its way into the alley behind Bleu), Monica ended up between James and Tyler, with Don seated next to Carrie. And then me, naturally, across from them all toward the front of the limo.

There was nothing to do but try and act like it didn't bother me – which I did a not-very-good job of – by acting like I was interested in stuff outside the window. Or by pretending to listen.

But Monica, Trey, and James were caught up telling stories from back in the day. The two men had their arms draped over the back of the seat, behind Monica. They weren't touching her, but the implication was clear. Their legs were spread wide, taking up space, asserting their physical dominance, marking their territory: and in the middle sat Monica and her petite frame, holding yet another glass of alcohol, laughing at everything they were saying.

I had no idea what they were talking about. Their voices were too low, and Carrie's high-pitched, millennial accent was drowning them out. I could only see that they were leaning in closer and closer.

And Don, who was listening to Carrie's incessant chatter and also having another drink, was watching my wife more than he was watching Carrie.

And then there was Monica. Monica who seemed to know this. Monica who knew that all eyes were on her, Monica who seemed to be having so much fun teasing me, by teasing me and teasing Don. She laughed, ran her fingers around the rim of her glass, brought them fluttering to her throat, and put her hand on Ty or James' chest to breathlessly tell a story.

She crossed her legs, and I caught a glimpse of her underwear. I wondered if Don had seen it, too. Her skirt continued to ride up her legs, and Ty did not even try to hide the fact that he was watching her lap, and the ever-creeping skirt. I imagined the view from where he was: the soft curve of Monica's scantily-covered breasts, hovering over the lines of her legs, crossing and uncrossing, her muscled thighs rippling as she did. With

every cross, a little more of her pale skin showing, the promise of seeing her panties, or maybe even her snatch, edging closer and closer into view...

The limo came to a stop, and Tyler at last looked up from Monica's lap. "We're here, folks," he said.

I had no idea where we had ended up at first, which may seem laughable because the clues were all there the whole ride to the place as people repeated the name of what I took to be an ordinary club. Staring at the sign: "Diamond Rodeo," I felt a bit stupid, but that's what happens when you drink too much.

At the outside of the building, seedy music was being played and men outnumbered girls ten to one. But it wasn't until we were actually seated in a VIP section and ordering drinks from a woman wearing nothing more than two pieces of faux leather in the shape of a "v" and fishnet stockings that I realized we were in a strip club.

It wasn't as if I'd never been in a strip club before. And it wasn't as if getting dragged to one with, and by, Don, was a new experience for me. And it wasn't as though this one was particularly different, though maybe it was a little more high-end than any I'd been in before.

I had just been so deep in the bubble of my thoughts about my wife and Ty (and all the other basketball players she'd evidently had so much fun with back in her cheerleading days) that I hadn't noticed the mirrored floors and ceilings, the naked women spinning acrobatically on poles, or the dark, red velvet interior.

As soon as I did realize where we were, I looked over at Monica.

I didn't expect her to be flustered: like I said, Monica was pretty chill and really liberal about all things sex, and in her book a strip club wasn't all that far out there. But I didn't expect her to be so chill that she wasn't even looking around, which is how I found her when I looked over. She was leaning casually on the red plush couch, her phone in her hand for some reason, her other hand propping up her head, chatting with another waitress as though they were best friends and they were just getting caught up.

Not only that, she was sitting next to Ty as though she had come here with him instead of me. Her dress had ridden up the length of her leg again, and so her thigh was mostly bare against his fancy suit. She had crossed this leg over the other and was making languid circles with her very sexy shoe.

Next to me, Don was openly staring at her legs, looking like he wanted to eat her. And to my left, so was James.

Two men, staring at my wife, in a club full of naked women swinging around poles.

I had a very uncomfortable erection by now, and I shifted in my seat, bumping the girl we were all calling Carrie, who laughed and threw her hair in such a way that it grazed my face. "What are you having?" she slurred.

"A beer," I said, my attention still on my wife in the corner of my eye.

"Nonsense," Don said. "You can't have a beer here!"

"Nah nah nah, nah," James said, wagging his finger at me. "You never been out with any brothers before, huh?" He laughed at his joke, and I smiled, even if it did make me uncomfortable because it was true. "We order Dom at the strip club, bro. If you know what I mean."

I really did not, but I nodded.

James smiled. He was being a good sport, because I was an easy mark: I'm sure my discomfort was vastly evident by now. He waved at the waitress who Monica was chatting up by closing and opening the fingers of his huge black hand. "Baby, come here," he said.

I leaned over to Monica, who gave me a strange smile and folded herself over her crossed leg to lean toward me. This had the effect of hiking her skirt all the way up to her ass, and I could see the whites of Ty's eyes shift to take the sight in. I decided to ignore it. "You know her?" I asked, referring to the waitress.

Monica smiled. For a moment she was quiet, then she leaned toward me and pulled me closer with her finger under my chin. "Relax. You're looking really nervous. Just have a good time."

She delivered this little sermon in a sexy voice, with a wine-flavored puff of air against my earlobe. Then she leaned back. Ty had extended his arm across the back of the couch, and so my wife landed right beneath it, under his wing so to speak.

But Ty had his eyes on the stage, not my wife, and Monica had her eyes on me. Don was talking to a waitress, and when he turned back to the group, Monica gave me a final look, and then turned her attention to Don.

She smiled. "How do you like this place?" she shouted at him.

And then she very casually lifted her leg to uncross it, but higher than she needed to, slower than she needed to, revealing her black underwear nestled between her thighs. Just as slowly and casually, she re-crossed her legs, the other one on top now. The move was so deliberate, and she did it

without taking her eyes off Don, that I felt like I had been punched in the stomach.

Then I noticed that Ty's attention had turned to Monica's long leg and the high heel she was waving just in front of his shin. He swept his eyes all over her leg, looked up at me, made no face at all, just burned his eyes into mine, and then turned his attention back to the stage.

Don hadn't answered Monica's question, and he leaned back with a smug smile like he had no intention of doing so, either.

We sat, having the half-conversations people have in that kind of place. A few more people joined the party – big, athletic-looking guys, some who seemed like fans, some friends. They came and went and didn't introduce themselves. I was about to suggest that we go home, when James stood up and patted me on the thigh.

"You comin'?" James said to me.

I looked at Monica for help. She shook her head slightly and a faint smile appeared on her lips.

"Uh, no man, I don't think so," I bumbled.

James looked from me to Monica and nodded, as though having thought about it, he agreed with it.

I leaned over to Monica. "Where're they going?" I said.

Monica smiled again, then shrugged. "Maybe..." she pantomimed doing a line of coke, "or maybe the 'champagne room.'" She said this like it was really seedy. Like the real, fabled champagne room.

My jaw dropped. "Not really?" I mouthed.

Monica shrugged again and reached for her tall glass, which had been emptied. She pouted and peered into the glass.

Don reached over and took it from her.

Now, I was pretty drunk, and bleary-eyed at this point, but I'm 100% positive I saw him stroke her pinkie finger with his pointer finger. A long, slow stroke, very deliberate and very blatant.

"What can I get you?" he asked her.

Monica brought a hand to her dress. "Oh, another... maybe a gin and tonic or something."

My eyes went wide. Monica turned to me after Don left. "I'm not drinking them," she mouthed. Then she pointed at Carrie, who was nearly falling off the couch. Tyler was saying something to her in her ear, and

Carrie was thirty sheets to the wind. I guessed that Monica meant she was giving her drinks to her.

Then, very suddenly, Monica stood up. She tugged her dress down and smoothed it around her form. "Gotta go to the ladies," she declared. She stepped toward me, and rubbed her knee on the inside of mine playfully. She gave her hair a toss, clutched her bag, and sauntered away.

I had no idea what to do with myself. I had been edged out of most of the girls' conversations, and James had disappeared. There were a handful of guys there, all of them in some way deep in conversation with the girls.

"What are you doing?" I mumbled to myself. Why were we here? I rubbed my head. We needed to go home. And that's what I was going to say to Monica when she got back.

Don returned, a waitress in tow with a trayful of drinks that she began setting on the table. Another bottle of champagne, a gin and tonic, and what looked like a Scotch and soda for Don. I watched the waitress set things on the table with a numb mind.

"Where'd Mon go?" Don yelled at me over the table, leaning closer.

At that moment, the place got a lot louder, and the crowd got a little rowdier, because an act was coming on stage with two girls who looked like twins in it. We surveyed the women for a few moments, maybe even a couple of minutes, because they were eye-catching blondes who were very, very flexible.

I looked back at the hallway where the bathrooms (presumably) were, looking for Monica. "She's in the bathroom," I said to Don, putting my mouth close to his ear to shout.

"Right," Don said. And then he tapped his watch.

I frowned. What the hell was that supposed to mean? Don just grinned over the edge of his glass.

Time seemed to drag on. I tried to concentrate on the two blondes on stage, their bountiful breasts swinging as they rolled their bodies against each other, grinding their round bottoms as they leaned over, ass to ass, and then spread their legs to do synchronized splits.

But even that distraction could not keep me from thinking about Monica, and how much time was ticking away.

"Hey man," Don said loudly, leaning over with his whiskey suddenly to talk to me. "This your first time?"

I turned to him sharply. "In a club?"

Don smiled. "Right. In a club."

I raised my eyebrows, like I had no idea what he was implying. But the way my stomach was falling through the floor, I knew what he was getting at: was this the first time I'd seen my wife flirt blatantly with another man?

"She's been gone a while," Don said. "James, too."

His voice was heavy with implications.

I just sat there staring at him.

And then my heart began to race as even more time ticked by.

"Excuse me," I said, pushing off the couch. "I gotta take a piss."

Ty had his hands all over Carrie, so that was one less thing to worry about. I stumbled through the crowd of men toward the hallway where I thought Carrie had disappeared. A stripper passed me and smiled.

"Hey where's the ladies room?" I slurred.

She smiled and waved a hand behind her, to a place where the hallway t-boned. Without indicating which way.

I turned right, and realized my mistake, but then I saw a sign for "The Champagne Room."

"Huh," I said aloud. There was actually a sign.

I don't know why, but I just decided to barge in. It had been far too long for Monica to have legitimately been in the bathroom.

I took the scene in front of me quickly: small mirrored stage/table, with a pole in the center. A buxom stripper with long brown hair spinning around on the pole. The huge body of James, spread out on a bench seat behind the table, his sunglasses still on. His head turned, his dark skin close to Monica's face. Monica's legs, folded underneath her, perched on the bench in a kneeling position. The other two girls and the guy who had joined us in the VIP section laughing, their legs piled on top of each other in a tangle.

My wife's mouth kept moving, close to James' face, even as her eyes slid sideways to the door where I was standing. James grinned, I suppose when he saw me, but there was no way to tell with his glasses on.

Monica pushed off and leaned back on the bench as I approached. She fell against me and smiled, running her fingers under my chin.

"What are you doing?" I said. "I thought you were going to the bathroom."

Monica kicked her feet out and placed one of them on James' lap. "I got sidetracked," she said. She looked up at me. "I'm sorry." She turned, her feet dragging across James' lap, and with a feline series of moves, she folded up, her ass in James' face and her arms toward me, then thrust forward, her breasts grazing my face, and then she sat down on her heels again, this time facing me. "I was just telling James about -"

But at that moment, who should walk in but the rest of the gang? Don first, followed by Tyler, with Carrie strung out against his arms.

Monica smiled and bit her lip, rolling her body toward me again. The way she was doing it, it not only gave me a nice view of her tits, up close, but it also gave James a very nice view of her ass. He was not avoiding it, either. "This should be fun," Monica said.

"Monica," I began, but she slid her hand from my thigh, where she had perched both of her hands, and down to the contours of my hard cock. She had it all figured out, I guess.

She gave her hair a toss and looked up at Don.

Again, I got a sinking feeling, and a terrific thrill, from the expression on her face. It was challenging and defiant, seductive and flirtatious, all at once. And all of it directed at Don, as if they had some kind of secret language between them.

"I brought your drink," he said, setting the gin and tonic down on the table.

My cock throbbed.

Monica did another sexy, over-the-line dance-like move, leaning back athletically so that her hair swung over James' lap and her breasts brushed up close to my chin. Then she leaned toward me and stroked her fingers over my crotch again. "I felt that," she whispered.

I wasn't sure what she said at first, and I sat there trying to figure it out while she rose up on her knees and reached for her drink.

Her feet, in their heels, were on James' lap now, and he was enjoying the view he had of her ass. I looked over and saw that his hand was on her calf. Moving slowly up and down the length of her leg.

"You need a seat," Monica said, pointing at Don. She popped up so that she was sitting on the table, both of her legs now lying against the inside of James' thigh, her feet between his legs.

Don, grinning smugly, pushed me gently over, and sat down next to me.

Monica gave me a look, and lifted one leg from inside James' thigh to place her foot between my legs. Her skirt, of course, rode up her ass, and her panties were visible to both me and James. Probably to Don, too.

My pulse was pounding, I was suddenly quite sober.

I had no idea what to do, or what Monica was going to do next.

James did, though. He started to move his fingers along Monica's calf, up to her knee, while Monica watched him with seemingly mild interest. Then she slapped his hand playfully. "Beast," she said. "I'm a married woman!"

James sucked on his lower lip. Monica was just laughing. But his hand stopped at her knee.

The girl who had been dancing on the table had stopped somewhere in all of this, and now she was talking to Tyler, who had found a seat on the opposite side of the booth.

"You gonna dance for us, Monica?" Don asked.

I whipped my head toward him.

Monica pushed herself backward with her feet and then started to scoot along on her butt, rocking from side to side to move. As she did, she started to spread her legs. The dress parted and slid up her thighs, catching under her moving bottom and hiking up around her hips. She pushed on the floor between her legs and lifted her bottom to move back until she reached the pole.

Monica spread her legs in a near-split, and the three of us were left staring at her long, flexible legs and the triangle of black panties between them.

"Maybe," Monica said, leaning her head back on the pole. "If there's a song I like."

James reached a long arm over to slap Tyler on the forearm. "Ty, buddy, get this girl a song she likes."

Tyler snapped out of the dance he was getting, to no music but the loud echoes from outside the door, and took in the scene on the table. Then he lifted the stripper on his lap to stand up. "Baby, how can I get a song in here?"

While they busied themselves with that problem – one I will never know exactly how they solved – James slid Monica's drink toward her on the table.

I was paralyzed. My wife looked like another person entirely. In the dim, red-tinged light of the room, her skin reflected on the mirrored table and ceiling and walls, nothing but the black strip of her panties covering her snatch in front of all these men, she seemed like someone out of a movie and not my wife.

Monica moved the drink across the table and placed it between her legs. She dipped her finger in the drink and then brought it to her mouth to suck it off.

“Mon, what you want?” Tyler called.

“Partition,” my wife said.

Without hesitation. Or a moment’s thought. As if she had been planning this evening all year long and waiting for this moment.

My mouth fell open a little. There was a pause while Tyler and the stripper did whatever they were doing to get the music on. Next to me, James spread out a little on the bench, like he was getting comfortable. His huge thigh leaned heavily against mine, and he sucked on his lower lip again.

Some music blared and Monica leaned back against the pole with her arms up. “That’s not it,” she said. The music cut off.

“Mon-” I started to say, although I was fairly grateful that the jagged, electronic zips of the beginning of “Partition” cut me off.

My wife transformed instantaneously.

I’ve seen Monica dance before. There are videos upon videos of her cheerleading routines. I see her do yoga and Pilates all the time, and for a while she was even piloting a pole-dancing fitness class. So it wasn’t like I was completely *unprepared* for the next bit.

She just had never danced... quite like *this*.

The song was extremely trashy, but Monica seemed to know it by heart, her body moving with every unexpected beat. She stretched her arms up along the pole and sort of dragged herself up with arm strength until she could fold her calves under her. With her legs still spread she swooped down, ass in the air, and leaned forward in a swan dive that took her back up to the pole, her breasts sweeping in front of me and then arching back and away.

In this half-kneel, and rolling her body in waves of taut muscle and delicious curves, she peeled her dress off in one swift motion and tossed it aside.

With an athletic hop timed perfectly to the music, she was perched on her heels, her ass against her ankles. I could see in the mirror that her ass was covered only by the strip of black satin thong that sweetly framed the shape of her butt.

She seemed to have preternatural (or perhaps practiced?) sense of what this looked like from behind, because as she rose in sinewy rolls of her body, she made sure to project her bottom at its best possible angle.

“Whoo!” Tyler exclaimed with glee. The stripper sat down in his lap and watched, and it was clear to see that she so far found Monica impressive.

My wife started dancing as if she had a choreographed routine to this song all ready to go. She took a long, slow spin around the pole, standing, moving with the music’s hard edges and stops to pose in a butt- or tit-thrusting posture.

But then, as the beat of the music picked up and the lyrics became raunchier, so did my wife. Quite suddenly she was flying through the air, spinning around the pole, her legs split open. Then they closed around the pole, and a jolt went through me as I’m sure it did through all the men watching, as I thought about the strength of her thighs closing around me, and my cock, the same way.

James expelled some air through his nose and slapped his thigh.

Monica leaned backward and stretched her arms out, spinning slowly down the pole, upside down, with her breasts bouncing slightly.

She came down and slid onto her back, and with the snap of the music she snapped her legs open wide, then crossed them, then snapped them open again. She drew her hands over her breasts at the same time.

It was an insanely hot display, the sexiest dancing or... well, anything, I’d ever seen Monica do.

My cock was throbbing, and my limbs were going cold with a mixture of jealousy and fevered anger as I stole a few glances at the men watching her. It was hard to believe that this woman was my wife, and it was also hard to believe, given this current display, that Monica hadn’t slept with all of these guys.

I wondered if this was how Monica had been, all those years back. Maybe she had been some kind of huge slut, and I was a fool for buying her story of hard-working student for whom cheerleading was an unglamorous way to pay through college.

Snap! Her legs popped open again and Monica, with her extreme dancer's body, lifted herself up to grab the pole with two arms and her legs still spread in a wide "v."

It's really the sort of thing you'd actually have to see to believe.

Up and down the pole she started to spin again, this time closely curled up on it. She thrust her ass in the air and then swooped out toward Tyler, and then Don, and then James, and finally me.

This seemed to go on for a glorious – and horrible – forever.

At last the music died down in rhythm to a set of chords and tinny dings, while Monica also calmed, stretching her body out on the table, slowly ending her corrupt and filthy dance.

When she stopped, and so did the music, she sat up, spun around easily, and stood up on the table. Tyler clapped, James made some kind of grunting noise and called her baby, Don grinned aggressively at me, and I brought my hands together mechanically because I had no idea what else to do.

Monica took a bow, and then she walked to the edge of the table to pick her dress up off the bench-seat where she had thrown it.

"Hey that ain't it, is it?"

Monica pulled her dress on and gave a spin. Her panties flashed at us tantalizingly. She stepped down the little stairway they had put there for the strippers, and walked to Don's side of the booth. "That's it for me," she said, and for the first time I was aware of how athletic her little show had been: she was slightly out of breath. "For now."

"Shit that was hot," James said, to no one in particular.

Monica nudged Don and he scooted slightly my way, but James wasn't going anywhere and there was only so much squashing I could do.

Monica sat down on Don's lap.

I wondered if she could feel the erection he surely had, against her ass. I wondered if she liked it.

"Well," she said. "Where to now, gents?"

She looked behind her, at me, as she said this. "Wanna go back and party at someone's hotel room?"

Tyler laughed, and I looked over in his direction to see that the laugh wasn't for me or Monica, but whatever the stripper had said in his ear. She was stuffing some cash into her little outfit (God only knows where she was putting it).

James was looking at Monica, and he shrugged. “Sure thing, little girl. Whatever you want.”

“I have a suite,” Don said. “At the Palace.”

Monica dropped her hand to his thigh, twisting a little to get a good look at me. “Perfect,” she purred. “That sounds lovely, doesn’t it?”

Chapter 8

I pulled Monica aside as the group made its way out of the “champagne room.”

She seemed to expect that I would do it. She had a smile on her mouth, one eyebrow raised, a look of partial amusement and partial defiance on her face.

“Monica what are you doing?” I hissed.

Her body rolled underneath mine as a laugh traveled the length of her body, throaty and sultry. “I’m getting in the limo, and going back to Don’s place.”

“I mean, what are you *doing*?”

She slid her hand down to my hard cock and leaned forward. “What do you want me to do?” she whispered.

My cock throbbed against her hand.

“That’s what I thought,” she said. She leaned back, smiled, and her eyes met mine.

“I thought you weren’t attracted to Don,” I said.

She turned her head, smiling. “I’m not,” she purred. And then she rolled her head back to me. “I mean, not really. It’s hard to explain.”

“Try,” I said.

She giggled. “We’re going to miss the limo,” she said.

I paused, unsure of what to do.

“And then we’re going to miss everything,” she added. “Is that what you want?”

“Explain what you mean,” I persisted. “About Don.”

I don’t know why, but I needed it explained. Maybe because I didn’t know what *my* deal was with Don, the man I both wanted to fuck my wife and not fuck my wife.

Monica took my hand and guided it between her legs, so I could feel her damp panties with my finger. I slid it under the material and my forefinger sank into a sea of tangy wetness. “It’s complicated,” she said. “I hate him, I really do... but...”

She pulled on my hand, and brought it to her mouth. Her hot, wet lips closed around my fingertips and sucked the juices from them.

“Guys!”

It was James’ voice. “Hummer’s leavin’ folks.”

Monica grinned at me again, and turned, swinging her hips as she walked toward James, who folded her under one of his muscled arms as if she belonged to him.

So what could I do?

I followed.

We climbed in to the Hummer-limo with what seemed like more people than we had started with. Carrie was somehow hanging on, and seemed almost reanimated (she’d started wiping her nose a lot, so I could take a guess on why that was.) The stripper from the champagne room and another girl who I was pretty sure was a cocktail waitress who had changed out of her outfit and into a tight pair of jeans and a shirt, climbed in with us as well. There were also a couple of guys who had been talking to Tyler at some point in the evening.

It had all gone by in a blur. I could see out the window that the club was closing, which meant it had somehow gotten very, very late.

There was a lot of very drunk and very confused jostling going on in the limo, as everyone found a seat, drinks were distributed, and ladies hopped from lap to lap. The cocktail waitress even sat on my lap at one point, and gave me a knowing smile when her small round bottom ground against my erection.

But I was not thinking about her, or anyone else in the limo except my wife. I couldn’t stop replaying her bringing my fingers to her mouth, over and over and over again, tasting her slimy excitement, telling me “it’s complicated.”

The cocktail waitress pushed off at some point, and she crawled onto the floor to get a drink. The other girls were laughing, and once the waitress cleared out I had a good view of my wife, who was sitting in the back seat between Don and Tyler. She was deep in conversation with Tyler and James, who was hulking in the seat next to them with another glass of alcohol in his hand.

But the part of the image that was really burning through me was that Monica’s hand was carelessly laid on Don’s thigh.

She wasn’t doing anything with it. It was just there.

And then, as though she saw me watching, she turned her head slowly, and met my eyes for a moment. A smile formed at the corners of her mouth, and then she turned back to the two big black men.

Don was looking at me as well, but I ignored him and looked at Carrie, who was dancing on her knees next to me on the floor.

We arrived wherever it was that we were headed, and the party began to pile out of the limo.

I remained seated, watching my wife, and Don, and James, the three of whom did not move.

Tyler fist-bumped James on the way out and said, “see you later man.” And then, from the outside, “Bye, bye Mon.”

So I knew something was up.

The door closed.

It was suddenly very quiet in the limo. Don got up and pressed the intercom. He gave the driver the name of a hotel, and I was only vaguely certain it was his.

Monica’s head rolled lightly side to side as she smiled at me and the car started moving.

Blood was going everywhere it shouldn’t inside my body. My cock was throbbing, my ears were thumping so loudly I could hardly hear them. James sipped his glass of alcohol, whatever it was. He had switched to something harder, and the whole evening, in fact, seemed harder.

Monica smiled and reached across him to the stereo system. “Let’s get some music going,” she said. “Or it might seem awkward in here.”

Don poured himself a glass of champagne. I remained where I was, seated at the front, far away from the three of them.

Monica fiddled with the stereo, her body strewn across James’ lap. She laughed when we turned a corner and she lost her balance a little and teetered on the edge of his knees. James placed a hand on her and kept her from falling.

“You gonna dance for us again?” he asked, when Monica selected a low, bass, R&B song.

Monica fell back into the seat. She shifted her gaze to me as she said, “I had something else in mind.”

She was slumped on the back seat, her legs akimbo, her dress riding high up around her hips.

She closed her legs, and for a moment, disappointment from all of us sucked the air out of the limo.

Monica drew her hands up to her hips and hooked her fingers on her panties. Then, as all three of us watched, she scooted them down, tugging first one side, then the other, until they reached her knees. There, she let them slide down her calves, gave one final tug as they rolled up – wet – around her ankles. She stepped out of them, first one foot, then the other.

For a breathless moment, she sat there, almost primly, with her knees together and all of us waiting to see what she would do next.

I stared as my wife leaned forward, and spread her legs open, drawing her dress up along her ribs. Her glistening pussy was bared, right here on the plush seats, for anyone in the limo to see.

She reached over to James' drink, dipped her finger in it, and brought it back to her pussy. She let whatever he was drinking dribble, ice-cold, over her bulging clit and into the folds of her gash. They were already shiny with her juices, so the liquid slipped into her slit almost unseen. Though I knew she could feel it, ice-cold and arousing, sliding between her legs.

James let out a low growl, and Monica watched him as he leaned forward on his knees, hooked his arms under her thighs, and jerked her body up. Her legs popped open like they had at the club, her spiked heels pointed at the ceiling.

Her back slid down along the back of the bench seat, but her head was about halfway up the seat. A golden halo of hair spread out behind her, clinging to the seat and framing her head. She brought one hand lazily to James' tight, close-shaven curls, as he disappeared between her legs. The other hand she brought to her mouth to chew on.

She burned a hole through me, staring into my eyes for a moment, James' head moving slowly between her thighs.

Then, with a sweep of her eyes that cut me in half like a scythe, she shifted her gaze to Don.

She began to move her pinkie finger slowly between her lips, looking at Don as she did. I heard her suck in her breath. She lifted one leg very high, and twisted a little.

By doing this, I could see, she was giving Don a view of James eating her out.

And Don was as mesmerized as I was. He stared at my wife's pussy as James darted his tongue around. I could hear the sticky sounds of his

tongue exploring her wet lips, but I couldn't see what Don could see.

And Monica was staring right at him. She popped her pinky finger out of her mouth.

"You like that?" she asked.

But the question was for Don, not for me.

Don took a sip of his drink. I couldn't decide if he was amused or uncomfortable and trying to hide it.

Me? I was just utterly stunned.

Monica drew her hand along the length of her upturned leg. She gripped James' head and looked down at what he was doing. "Oh fuck, that's good," she said to him, her voice quivering like her thigh. She ran her hand up and down her leg. "So good..."

My cock was so hard at that point I felt like it might split in two. But I had no idea what to do. We were in a car for fuck's sake, familiar sights of the city passing by the windows, and my wife was poised like a filthy stripper while some former NBA player ate out her pussy. And who was she talking to? Don.

I loved it.

I couldn't move.

"Oh!" Monica said. "Oh, just like that, oh, fuck, that feels so good. I'm going to come. Oh my God!"

As Monica held her leg and kicked her foot, biting her lip and mewling as she came, the limo rolled to a stop in front of Don's hotel.

But James kept going, until Monica grasped his head. "Oh, stop," she said. She dropped her leg to the ground and pushed him away. "I can't take any more," she said.

James rose up and pulled my wife by the neck to his mouth, which he swallowed up in his big lips.

I looked at Don, who was staring with the same cool look as before. But he was turned on – that much was abundantly evident.

When James released her from his wet, filthy kiss, Monica's lipstick was slightly smeared. She ran her tongue along James' lips, cleaning her pussy juices from his mouth. Then she wiped the smeared corner of her own mouth and tugged on her dress. "Well," she said. "I guess we're here."

Monica leaned forward and picked her panties up from the floor. She put them on my lap on her way out. They were soaked and cool to the touch.

She got out of the limo, and James looked at us. Don followed, then me, then James.

Monica didn't miss a beat. She asked Don for his room key, and led us all upstairs.

I wanted to pull Monica aside, and see where all of this was going. Maybe I wanted to put the brakes on it. But something – probably a dark desire to *not* put the brakes on it at all – kept me at the back of the pack as we filed toward the elevator.

The doors opened as soon as Monica pressed the button, so by the time I got in, Monica had already turned to James and started kissing him. Don tried to move in and sandwich her, but Monica deftly moved a hand to his chest and pushed him away. The push was gentle; she stroked his chest and used her fingers to loosen his tie, but nonetheless it was a push.

I leaned against the railing on the left side of the elevator. I was starting to feel less uncomfortable, sinking into the role of voyeur.

The elevator came to a stop, and the bell dinged, announcing the floor: ten.

Monica broke her lip lock with James. She smiled at me and leaned forward to kiss me as she stumbled through the door, dragging Don by his tie behind her.

James followed them, and I lingered, the wet taste of my wife's mouth on my lips. I tasted the faintest trace of her own tangy juices, that had lingered on James' lips and then went back to hers as she sucked on his mouth in the elevator.

Don's room was a suite. Monica opened the door and we were suddenly in a large room with high ceilings. The kind of room that appears in the ads for hotels but you (or at least people like me) never actually get: a bathtub that was more like a pool, a fireplace dividing the sitting area and bedroom with glass fronts to each side. A big balcony with real furniture on it.

Monica whistled, which is something she's terrible at. Then she kicked off her shoes and stepped down a small set of steps to the sunken sitting area. She headed for the bar.

Don followed and sat down on the low couch. He fished something out of his suit pocket. I watched, leaning on the wall, not following them into the suite.

James went behind Monica and slid his hands on her hips. He murmured something into her ear and she laughed.

I heard the clatter of plastic on glass, and saw that Don was creating some lines of white powder.

Monica was making drinks with James pawing at her, giggling softly. Don looked up at me, a rolled bill in his fingers. He gave me a look and extended the bill, but he knew I was going to turn it down. I shook my head, but he was already leaning forward to take his first hit.

Monica turned around. She had some drinks in her hand. Her eyes went to Don, and the scene of him snorting coke, and then she looked at me. Leaving James to make his own drink, she slinked across the room and up the stairs. She handed me a drink: a whiskey soda by the looks of it.

She took a sip of her own drink, looking at me over the rim of the glass.

“Mon, you want a hit?”

James was asking the question, settling his big bulk into the couch.

Monica turned and surveyed the situation. “I don’t do that shit,” she said.

But she dropped down the steps, in this very sexy and inviting gait, her eyes on the table. Don grinned at her, as if he knew some secret.

“It’s a real aphrodisiac,” Don said.

Monica was close to the table now. “Oh it is, is it?” she purred.

She was on the side of the edge closest to Don. She put her finger in her mouth, leaned over, and swept up half a line on her forefinger. Then she stood erect and rubbed it on her gums and sucked it off her finger.

Don shook his head. I couldn’t tell if he was impressed or disappointed that his coke was being improperly consumed.

James stretched out on the couch, spreading his legs wide like he had at the club. “You gonna dance for us again, pretty thing?”

Monica shrugged. “You have any music?” she asked Don.

Don took his phone out of his pocket and started fumbling around with it. Monica took a sip of her drink and watched him.

“I’m pretty fucked,” Don said, laughing. “What do you want?”

Monica took his phone away. It slipped from her hand and she laughed. “I guess not,” she said.

Before there was any time to process what she said, she had her hands on the bottom of her dress, and was pulling it up and over her head.

I had forgotten that Monica had no underwear on. Just her little bra. James raised his eyebrow. "Okay," he said. "I guess we're gettin' down to business."

Monica reached behind her and unfastened her bra. The material sprung loose and forward, and she did a little shimmy to get it off. I could see her reflection in the window, breasts jiggling for her audience of two.

I sank to the floor, sitting on the steps. I was unable to believe that this was really happening. Too excited to stop it, consumed to uselessness by jealousy.

She was still wearing her heels, so the long lines of her legs appeared even more carved of lean muscle than normal. I admired Monica's taut ass, her trim waist, the lines of her body that were firm and athletic but curved and sweet.

James sucked on his lower lip. Don stared, a smug expression on his face. I could see that he was pleased to be finally getting closer to what he craved: sticking his cock in my wife.

"Now you," Monica said. She put her hand on her hip.

The "you" seemed to be only for James and Don, because she was facing them and didn't look back at me. Again, like in the elevator and the limo, I faded into a place of pure voyeurism, and Monica, James, and Don seemed fine with it.

Maybe I did, too.

James stood up and walked toward Monica. He had been wearing a shiny, expensive-looking shirt that he was popping the buttons off of as he pulled it apart. He shrugged it away as Monica picked up the glass she'd set down to take off her dress, and brought the liquid to her mouth.

She ran her fingers playfully over his belt buckle, but didn't help him out of it.

Don loosened his tie and pulled it off his neck. He remained seated, watching the two of them, unbuttoning his shirt slowly.

James unbuckled his belt and slid it out of his pants. He tossed it on the couch, his other hand unbuttoning his fly. Monica ran her fingers down his chest as his pants dropped, so that by the time she reached his pelvis, there were only silk boxers between her fingers and the large cock that suspended the silk in front of him.

She played with the top of his boxers while he watched her fingers. I finished off my drink. I was really quite drunk, I realized.

I stared as my wife's hand dipped into the black silk of James' boxers. "Oh, my," she said. "All the stereotypes are true."

James edged his boxers off with one hand, while he moved the other along my wife's torso, over her nipples and up to her throat. He clutched her jaw in his giant hand and tipped her head back a little.

I didn't know where to put my eyes: his hand on her jaw, his fingers brushing over her lips? Or her pale hand clasped around the very thick, dark length of his shaft.

The world started to swim in front of me. This was real, this was happening. That was my wife, and her hand, and it was stroking another man's cock.

A mixture of horror and elation rushed through me, as my wife leaned forward. Her tongue followed her hands, passing over James' hard pecs, his lean muscles, his tights abs. She slid slowly, and with a dancer's control, to her knees.

Her hands found James' cock again, and she massaged it as she looked at it, almost like she was deciding how to eat it.

Monica gave a toss of her hair, and turned her head sideways.

To look at Don.

I could see the side of her face, so when she smiled I saw the shape of it clearly. I could also see her pink tongue as it emerged from her mouth, and that her eyes were on Don as she flicked her tongue against the crown of James' dick.

Don brought his hand to his head, two fingers against his temple.

James brought his hand around to the back of Monica's head. He was looking down at her, and it was clear the only thing on his mind was getting her mouth on his cock. I watched his fingers mingle with her flaxen hair, chocolate in gold, palming her head like a basketball.

And then Monica's head moved forward, and though I couldn't see it, I knew: all the veiny, dark inches of James' cock were disappearing into her mouth.

And Don had a view of it all.

I don't know how long the moment lasted: my wife's head bobbing back and forth, James' fingers in her hair, the gold locks scraping lightly against her shoulders with every change of motion. Don, enjoying himself immensely, watching with a better view than mine as my wife sucked on James' cock.

Monica ended her blow job suddenly, pulling her head back and away and looking up at James, who still cradled her head in his hand but allowed her to stop. Monica rose to her feet and moved to the couch. James stroked his cock languidly, turning with her so he could watch what she was doing.

My wife got on the couch, her hands on the big armrest. Flinging her hair again, she looked back over her shoulder at Don. She could have stolen a glance at me, but she didn't: her eyes were on Don as she slid her hand down between her legs and slipped two fingers into her pussy.

She was watching Don's reaction, and I could see that it was pleasing to her to tease him like that.

She flipped her head back and looked up at James, who moved toward her and dragged his cock along her body: first over her lips, across her cheek, down her back, and then, as he climbed onto the couch, over the round curve of her ass.

The view was better for me now, though Don still had a choice view: he could see my wife's dripping cunt if he leaned to the side, which he did.

But I could see James' cock as he guided it to Monica's pussy. He moved the crown over her lips and her clit, eliciting a squeal of pleasure from Monica.

"Damn, your pussy is so wet," he said.

I could hear that it was: with each swirl of his cock, a squelching sound came from between Monica's legs.

"You ready for it?" James asked.

Monica took her fingers from between her legs, drawing them along her belly and over her breasts. She played with her own nipple at the same time that she looked up at me.

And then, with her eyes locked on mine, she brought her fingers to her mouth again. "I'm ready," she breathed.

James' thick black snake slowly inched forward, disappearing into Monica's pussy. Monica slid her fingers back into her mouth, and her eyelids seemed to grow heavy. She moaned as James filled her pussy with cock, all the way to the hilt.

I supposed this was how I always imagined it, secretly, knowing that Monica had been a cheerleader for a professional basketball team. How could it have been any other way? Though she had always denied it – by brushing me off, mostly – how could anything else have been true? My wife had played out this scene countless times. Maybe even with James himself.

I stared at my wife, who opened her eyes and looked at me with her fingers in her mouth. My cock was so hard it was painful, and my insides twisted with the pain of the imagined past that was flooding my mind, and the scene in front of my very eyes: an undeniable truth. My wife was being fucked by an athletic black man with an enormous cock.

James began slowly, and Monica kept looking at me. Her hair swung lightly back and forth, her mouth turned up slightly in a smile. But then he started to fuck her harder, and she had to drop her fingers to hold onto the armrest of the couch.

She dropped her head as well, and her hair covered her face.

She mewled with each thrust into her pussy. James was sloshing inside of her cunt, fucking her harder with every thrust. When Monica let out a cry, her voice wobbled in her chest because James was digging into her so hard.

My stomach dropped further. Was Monica going to let this guy fill her pussy up with cum?

Did I want that?

Don rose to his feet. I barely noticed, until he crossed my line of vision and interrupted the view of my wife being defiled – and reveling in it – by James.

I blinked. He had shrugged off his pants and underwear and was naked, his physique admirably fit for his age. He walked with his cock in his hand, stroking it with the same languid strokes that James had stroked his own cock: a man confident that he was about to get his dick wet.

He stood next to Monica, at an angle at the end of the armrest. Monica lifted her head; her hair was sticking to her face and her cheeks in slick wet strands where she was sweating.

She looked at Don's cock, then up at him.

James continued to slam into her pussy, and Monica opened her mouth, still grinning at Don. She leveraged her hand on the armrest and pushed her hair out of her face. Her tongue came out of her mouth, and it seemed she was about to lick his cock.

Instead, she flicked her tongue and didn't even touch it. She turned her head, pursing her lips, like she was going to kiss his cock on the side... but she only breathed on it, while Don's cock pulsed in his hand and he stared at her.

She made several passes this way, her head bobbing forward as James fucked her, but never losing control of herself. Don tried to lean forward, and Monica managed to pull away, always teasing, never touching her mouth to his cock.

And then, just as it seemed that Don couldn't take any more, Monica pushed up and back from the armrest with her enormous strength. She did it gracefully, arching her back, but obviously pushed hard so that James had to sit back on his heels.

Monica fell onto his lap, impaling herself on his cock.

James wrapped his hands under her ribcage and got his hands full of my wife's tits as she bounced slowly on his cock. I could tell by the way that his thighs flexed he wanted her to move faster, but Monica took her time and rolled slowly up and down his shaft.

Because her legs were so strong, she could do this like it was a walk in the park, slowly rising up to a half-kneel, showing Don the length of James' cock, and then slowly burying James inside of her again.

I managed to get up on my feet and walk toward the mini bar where Monica had made her drinks. I wanted a better view, the view that Don had, and vaguely I thought that making a drink would give me the pretext – as if anyone cared – to go stand there.

I just grabbed a bottle (perks of a real hotel room, the bottle was large) and leaned against the bar. From where I was, I had a perfect view of Monica's breasts, being kneaded by James' large hands. His big lips on her neck, his breath against her neck and ears. His cock between her legs, in and out, sticky and wet.

And Don, who had no idea how to get in there, holding his throbbing cock.

Monica got an impish look on her face. "You like watching me get fucked, don't you?"

This was directed at Don. She was using her phone-sex operator's voice. She dropped her hand and reached out, palm up, for Don's cock.

He got onto the couch, sort of blocking my view, so I moved a little along the bar and collapsed in a chair. I was so wasted, too wasted – not wasted enough that my cock wasn't aching more painfully than I had ever felt in my life, but too wasted to stand up.

I watched as Monica closed her hand around Don's cock. "I bet you'd like to see me get this big, hot cock in my ass, wouldn't you?" She bit her

lip. “Maybe you’d like it if I ran my tongue up and down your shaft while James made my ass sore and then you could come all over my face?”

Monica’s hand was moving faster now. James was leaning back, squeezing his eyes – Monica was moving too slowly for him and he was brushing up against the peak of coming, but never quite getting there. He pulled on Monica’s hips and jammed his cock deep inside her.

“I bet you wish you could get as deep inside my hot pussy as that, don’t you?” Monica asked Don. “And then fill me all up with your cum?”

But she already knew that he wasn’t going to make it that far. She smiled, she could feel in her hand that he was already boiling over.

James lost it then, too, just as Don did. My wife jerked Don off rapidly as thick ropes of cum splayed across her belly and her arms, onto her thighs. And James groaned, looking up at the ceiling, filling my wife’s pussy with his load of cum.

“Fuck!” Don yelled.

Monica continued to jerk him off and slam onto James’ cock, until her eyes drooped and she bit her lip. Her body shuddered as she enjoyed her own orgasm.

Then she released Don, and he fell back against the armrest. She brought her hand to her mouth and licked it, looking at Don. She leaned back against James, who was leaning back on the couch, his long, long arms supporting him. His chest moved up and down quickly, but he recovered fast.

Athletic.

Monica dropped her hand and played with the cum on her thigh absent-mindedly, then rose up on her knees. James’ thick cock, still semi-hard, flopped out of her pussy.

She stepped neatly onto the carpet, cum running down her legs – both Don’s where he had ejaculated on her, and James’s, spilling from her cunt. She was still wearing her heels, so she looked spectacular: beautiful, in control, satisfied, and filthy.

She walked over to me, smiling. She took the bottle of whiskey from my hand, and took a long sip of it. Then she set it down on the minibar.

Monica stepped over my legs, straddling me. I had a nice view of her dripping, sticky thighs as she did so. The scent of two men’s cum, and her bountiful juices, stung in my nose. A stain of precum had spread across the

pants of my suit, and Monica ran her fingers over it. The touch felt like a punch in the nuts, I was so hard and dying for release.

She used one hand to unfasten the suit, pull on my zipper, and take out my cock.

Her legs came back around and between mine, and she dropped onto her knees.

I looked up. Don was watching, still reclined on the armrest. His expression was one of curiosity, maybe interest. James was shaking his head. His expression was one of disbelief.

Monica's mouth closed around my cock, and I shuddered at her touch. She smiled, grazing the tender ridge of my crown with the edges of her teeth – not biting, just smiling – and then her lips and her soft mouth consumed me inch by inch.

She swirled her tongue around me as she went down, and then she started to suck on me as her fingers crept up from beneath her and brushed over my balls.

I lifted a hand to put it in her hair, and as I did the memory of Monica's blonde hair and her head cradled in James' hand like a basketball rushed into my mind, and I knew I was gone. Monica sucked the cum out of my cock and I leaned back in the chair, groaning as I filled her mouth with my seed.

The pleasure of my climax was so intense, my eyes rolled back in my head and I fiercely gripped her hair. It drained everything from me. Monica's tongue kept busy, swirling around the length of my shaft. I wanted to double over with the painful intensity of it, but I could barely move. The whole evening swam in my mind, swam in all the booze I'd drank, filled me with despair and erotic pleasure... my wife is a slut, I remember thinking, with both horror and extreme pleasure.

And then, I must have drifted off to sleep.

Chapter 9

A headache was coming, that's the first thing I felt. It was traveling from the back of my head forward. I rolled my head from side to side, and the pain sent my brain rocketing through layers of consciousness to fully awake – and regretting it – with eyes closed, bracing for something awful.

It was in this state, not sure of where I was, positive I needed to think about it before I opened my eyes, that I heard them.

“I know you're dying to see the difference. Come on.”

Don.

And then a throaty laugh.

Monica.

I opened my eyes.

I got nothing for my efforts except a view of the ceiling.

I noticed, then, that music was on. Something R&B, something sexy, but too low to really make it out. The lights were dimmer than they had been before. And it smelled like cigarette smoke.

I slowly edged my chin down, shifting my view.

I immediately closed my eyes to just barely open when I saw the scene in front of me: Monica, lying in the center of the couch, legs not really spread but not really closed. She had her dress on, but no panties, and she was moving her legs around so that her pussy darted in and out of view – of me, and of Don, who was sitting on the floor, leaning on the glass table. The table had been pushed aside, so it was off-center from the couch now.

I peered around the room and listened. No sign of James.

Monica had her pinkie in her mouth again. She reached forward and slapped Don playfully as he moved closer to her. “Come on, what have you got to lose?” he was saying.

“I said no,” Monica told him, laughing carelessly.

Don put his hands on her thighs. “You'll be so happy you gave it a try,” he said.

Monica looked at him, as though she were thinking it over.

“I want to watch you,” she said at last, rising up from the back of the couch in one of those rolling dance moves that used only her abs. She

stretched her arms out to Don's shoulders. "Then we'll negotiate."

Don's head moved from side to side. "I want to fuck you," he said. "I want to fuck you while you talk dirty to me."

Monica smiled wryly. "Hmm," she said simply.

"Don't tell me this has all been an act."

Monica smiled again. "Come on," Monica told him. "Here."

She leaned to her right, stretching across the table, and that's when I saw there was some room service lying around on the coffee table.

Monica picked up a cracker with a topping and fell back onto the couch. "Come onto this caviar," she said.

Don laughed, as if in disbelief.

"Please," she said, trailing her hand down his chest. "I'll eat it after you do."

Another disbelieving snort from Don, though with less conviction.

My pulse raced.

Monica shrugged and started to bring the cracker to her mouth. She bit into it and moved her fingers sensually over her mouth to get a dribble of caviar that escaped her bite. "No?" she said. "Well, that's all you'll get from me."

Don leaned back on his heels. He was in boxers, nothing more.

"Yeah?" he said.

Monica shrugged again and popped the cracker into her mouth. "Take it or leave it. But if you do it, maybe next time..."

Don made another snorting sound.

Then he reached over to the table, and took a cracker from the plate and dipped it into a bowl.

It was very hard not to move or open my eyes, and stare in disbelief or make a sound, as I watched Monica lean up on her arm and look down at Don as he jerked himself off. I could hear the sound of him stroking his cock, and then a low groan.

Monica smiled, shook her hair from her shoulder, and reached down to the floor.

She lifted the cracker, which was piled unevenly with black caviar and quite clearly – filthily – dripping with a glob of cum. She let a blob of it fall off before she popped the cracker into her mouth whole. Then she licked her fingers, and fell back onto the couch.

Don fell backward onto the floor. “You are such a crazy bitch,” he said.

“You know it tastes basically the same as caviar?” Monica said. “Hmm.”

She looked over at me.

“Oh hey,” she said. “You’re awake.”

I noticed then that it was light outside. Bright, in fact.

Monica stood up. “Well,” she said. “I’m bushed.”

She walked over to the stairs, hopped up them, and I heard the bathroom door close.

I looked down at my rumpled suit. Awkward. I had an erection, and I zipped up my pants and stumbled out of the chair. I felt for my wallet – good, still had it.

“Where’s, uh... James?” I asked Don, who had rolled up to sitting with his arms around his knees.

“He had a flight or something,” Don said.

The bathroom door opened and Monica came to stand by the landing of the steps. “Ready?” she asked. “Bye, Don.”

And then she turned and left.

I shrugged and limped toward the steps. My foot had fallen asleep, and there was no hiding it. It wasn’t enough to distract me from my erection, but enough to make me grimace. “See ya,” I said to Don, and I followed my wife out the door.

Monica swished ahead of me, her hair wavy and wild, some kind of light shrug over her shoulders that she had produced from seemingly nowhere. When she looked back at me, she smiled: she looked ten years younger, wild and slutty. Her mascara was smeared in thick lines under her eyes, but she had tidied it up enough that it almost looked purposeful. She had even applied some lip gloss, and her mouth was pink and smelled like cheap strawberry gloss.

She punched the elevator button, but then seemed to think better of it. She turned and kept walking, to the stairs.

I followed, and we fell into an embrace up against the wall as though we had choreographed it.

“How long were you awake?” she said, smiling.

I was fumbling with my pants, getting myself out, and staring at her glossy lips. I nibbled at them, and the sweet taste of whatever she had

applied clung to my mouth. But deeper inside, I knew, I knew she had the filthy taste of another man.

With my cock free, I yanked on her legs and pulled her up and over my hips. Monica squeezed me tight in her thighs, and pushed back on the wall – this way, I barely had to hold her. She made a sound like a tiger.

I used one hand to feed my cock into her soaked pussy. As all of her wetness closed around me, I wondered how many times she had fucked James that night, or Don, and how much of the silky slime I was sinking into was their cum.

The thought only drove me wilder, and I slipped my hand up behind her head and pulled her to me, fucking her as hard as I ever had, until I filled her stretched and used pussy with my own cum.

We exited through the stairwell, holding hands, laughing a little when the desk clerk gave us a look. We looked trashy as hell, but it felt good to be on the wilder side of things.

If only you knew, buddy, I thought.

We took an Uber and didn't talk about the night until he dropped us at our car. We got inside and sat in the silence of the underground lot. It was ten-thirty, so the cars were all still, everyone at work.

"Want breakfast?" Monica said.

"Uh... well, first off," I said. "I think I'm too drunk to drive still."

Monica laughed. "Probably."

I turned to her. "And second off..."

Monica looked at me, leaning her head against her hand.

"What's the deal with you and Don?" I said.

Monica smiled. "You just saw the deal."

I half-closed my eyes. "Okay... but... what is that?"

Monica leaned close to me. "I know," she said.

This sent a jolt of panic through me, the way I think it would for anyone. Even though I didn't know what it was that Monica thought she knew.

"Know what?" I asked.

Monica rolled her eyes. "I saw you. I saw you in Aspen..." she laughed. "You're not that sneaky, you know. And then... I mean you get totally turned on every time I talk about having sex with some guy. I know you *want* me to sleep with Don."

“So wait... but what just happened last night...”

Monica shrugged. “What happened last night was... complicated.”

This drove me to the point of madness.

“I just... dammit, Monica. Do you want to have sex with him or not?”

Monica looked out the window, thinking it over. “I want to fuck with him,” she said finally. Then she looked at me. “Do you want me to have sex with him or not?”

I didn’t know. I didn’t actually know if I thought Monica’s fucking with Don was better or worse than her fucking Don.

“I don’t know!” I yelled.

Monica tapped her lips. “Neither do I, okay? I mean, I sort of can’t stand him. You know? But I’m attracted to him. But I don’t want to go there either.”

There was a pause, while my mind churned and I stared at her in disbelief.

“So...” she let out a sigh. “I tease him.”

I stared at her.

She looked at me. “I thought it was sort of a compromise. He likes it, you like it... and we can still go to Aspen without it being all...awkward.”

My head was spinning. “And James?”

Monica leaned back against the headrest. “Ah, James... well, that was lucky wasn’t it? I was just planning on flirting with Don and dragging things out for... years or something. Who would have thought he knew Tyler and those guys, and we’d see them here?”

I looked out the windshield at the parking lot. “So... that was all just.... unplanned?”

“I think on my feet,” Monica said cheerfully.

I thought on this a while.

“Don’t act like you didn’t like it,” she said.

“No, I did, there’s no doubt... just...”

“Just what?”

I shrugged. “I don’t know.”

Monica touched my thigh. “*What?*” she insisted.

I rolled my head to look at her. “Well... you seemed awfully familiar with James...”

Monica laughed. “Okay. Truth.”

She paused, as I cringed in anticipation of the worst.

“I slept with James....”

I waited.

“Last night for the first time, you ass!” She slapped me on the thigh.

I rubbed my face. “Sorry,” I said.

I frowned into the parking lot.

“What now?” Monica said.

“What’d I miss? You know, while I was sleeping?”

Monica waited again, tantalizing me with her silence and her smile.

“Really, really, bad caviar,” she said finally.

We laughed.

There was a long pause while we looked out the window. There was more I wanted to say, but after a certain amount of time went by, it seemed strange to start the conversation up again. Just then, anyway.

“Want brunch?” I asked.

And so we went. Walking.

I suppose I did have some more questions, and I suppose it’s possible Monica may never give me all the answers. But there will be more trips to Aspen, in fact there’s one coming up later this year.

So that’s the story of my wife, and how she became a hotwife.

That’s the story, so far....

MORE FROM ARNICA BUTLER

APOLOGY!

Due to a glitch in the Amazon system, I've had to remove direct hyperlinks from my backmatter. I apologize for any inconvenience this causes my readers. Any of these titles can be located on [My Author Page](#)

Romantic Hotwife Books By Arnica:

Ela's Performance

Peter's sweet-faced and fiery wife is headed back to school for a degree in violin performance. Unexpectedly, Peter finds himself becoming very paranoid about who Ela is spending so much time with, and what she is doing at school so very late. It isn't as if he doesn't have his reasons for suspicion. There's the way his own relationship with Ela started, and their own past experiment with an open relationship before they were married. A few other strange things to fuel his jealous fantasies...

And when he discovers someone from Ela's past has resurfaced, he'll take a chance and confront his own desires and obsessions...but will he get what he really wants?

The Houseguest

Sharing and temptation...and sharing temptation. An old buddy returns to Erik's hometown, down on his luck and getting a divorce. By offering to let Ethan stay with them, Erik sees a way to get closer to making his wife-sharing fantasies a reality. To his delight, Natalie seems to be game for something far more adventurous than ever before. But as things heat up, Erik can't help but wonder: Who's seducing whom?

A Conventional Hotwife

Paul Banks was thrilled when a luggage mix-up five years ago opened a window of opportunity for his long-buried desires. Since that time, he and

his wife have been playing a little game at their yearly company conventions, and every year his wife ups the ante, going further into his fantasies. But Kathy Banks might be getting just a bit out of control, and things might be going a little too far...

Or not.

The Hotwife Summer

When Ben and Summer have the chance to spend the summer in Italy, their stale marriage starts to heat up in ways Ben could only have dreamed about. Summer is ready to take his hotwife fantasy all the way, and her choice is a sexy, Italian, Michelin star-studded chef. It's too late to put the brakes on what he's set in motion when Ben discovers the humiliating truth about Summer's choice of man. Summer has a taste for being naughty, and a filthy little plan of her own. Will it be everything he could wish for, or will Ben's cuckold fantasy turn into a nightmare he can't escape?

Body of Research

When ever-suspicious Chris plays private detective on his wife's phone and finds that she uses dozens of dating apps, he worries that his darkest fantasies have come true. And it may not be as delicious as he had imagined.

It turns out that Jen is up to something other than cheating, and the door is open for the two of them to explore the boundaries of their marriage. But in any experiment, the results can be unexpected...

The Hobby Job

Former career professional Laura is going crazy living her stay-at-home-mom life in a small country town. Her husband Conrad has the perfect solution: get a "hobby job." Laura gets turned on to the idea, and to Conrad's surprise, chooses to wait tables at a run-down restaurant down the street. But she gets a lot more than a hobby job when she meets Nate, a

young, hot waiter who has his eyes on her from the start.

Conrad and Laura start on separate journeys, exploring new possibilities in their marriage, and opening up to their hidden desires, fantasies, and needs. Will their journeys merge, or will Laura's "hobby job" make a hobby of their marriage?

The Hotwife Tattoo

When Greg's brother marries his wild, tattooed, ex-girlfriend Renee, he knows things will be a little complicated. But when Renee befriends his wife Sara, she starts to change in almost unbelievable ways. Greg sees that there is something more to Renee's plans than just friendly sister-in-law bonding. Is Renee's influence all bad, or can Greg get something he has always wanted and never admitted to his wife – maybe even himself?

Interracial hotwife books by Arnica:

Interracial Hotwife Bundle

Includes *The Tenant*, *Not Black and White*, and *Grand Slam* for \$5.99

Lisa Plays Her Part

Lisa and Luke married young because of an unexpected pregnancy, and Lisa never had much experience with other men as a result. But when a dark, handsome, wealthy man she almost slept with (and always wondered about) resurfaces in her life, Lisa is confronted with agonizing desires... and choices. Now that their nest is empty and they don't have the same reasons to stay together, will Lisa and Luke reconnect, or will Lisa choose to make this the final act of their marriage?

Megyn For The Win

In Megyn's view, nothing could be sillier than entering a charity contest to win a "date" with the sexy black celebrity Max Riley, not even to raise

money for underprivileged youth. (Un)fortunately for her, her friend entered her in the contest anyway.

When she wins, her husband Peter sees a chance to dip into a fantasy of his. But when this brush with fate turns into a very real, permanent job offer for Megyn - one that puts her in close and frequent contact with the famed black actor - the couple has a lot more to think about than just a winning a “date.”

A romantic, interracial hotwife story with a win at the end!

Claudia Changes Tack

Mike is on his friends' luxury sailboat with his stunning blond wife Claudia, hoping for nothing more than to convince Claudia that sailing is enjoyable. It turns out that his friends are swingers, in the Caribbean for more than just the sailing. And it turns out that Claudia has a streak of voyeurism in her. The couple embark on a mild adventure of exploration and sexual reawakening on the warm, beautiful beaches of the Caribbean, and it seems like the ideal vacation.

Grand Slam: An Interracial Hotwife Adventure

Charles keeps a secret desire about his wife Zoe. Her sizzling beauty is typically hidden under scrubs and a hair bun, so his fantasy may never happen. But a wrong turn on a weekend getaway turns out to be the opening pitch of a very naughty game, and Zoe seems determined to knock it out of the park.

The Tenant: A Very Naughty Hotwife Novel

Once upon a time, his exotic and incredibly sexy wife Anna loved to indulge Brian's fantasies...to a point. She teased strangers, and took them to cruel, tantalizing places. But she never went all the way. The game ended when Brian and Anna got married, and that was that.

Or was it?

When the gorgeous, charming, and very black John moves into their basement rental, Brian finds that his sleeping desires have been building up all these years. He doesn't just want Anna to tease. He isn't just toying with the idea. He is obsessed with driving his wife to do things with another man. Lewd things. Obscene things.

When he confesses his desires, is Anna just a little bit too willing to make things just like old times? Is she too easy to push over each new line? Brian can't help but wonder if his own obsessions have gone too far...or if Anna's have.

Not Black And White

When a photographer turns Rick on to the idea of watching his wife with another man, Rick feels an obsessive desire inside of himself catch fire. He can't help arrange for his shy, girl-next-door wife Danielle and the rugged, black photographer to cross paths. He knows that Drake Reyes' erotic photographs are not as abstract as they appear, and that Reyes sleeps with his married models. He knows his wife is not immune to Reyes' charms – no one is. He just can't help but imagine what it would be like to stand in his gallery, looking at Reyes' lurid photos, knowing his own wife is the model, knowing how the photos were taken. But was it really his idea, or have Drake and Danielle been as manipulative as he has?

Please note, this is the novelized version of the short story Black and White, with significant changes to all scenes depicted in the short story, as well as the point of view. There is, however, some repetition: scenarios which occurred in the short occur in the novel. There are plenty of fresh new adult scenes, however. Please enjoy.

Unlocking Noel: A Reluctant Hotwife Novel

Pretty, bookish Noel is not exactly an adventurer in or out of the bedroom, and Spencer has come to accept that. But things take an unexpected turn

one year at an annual ski vacation. When they return the following year, Spencer gets to work on unlocking Noel and her (literally) dark desires.

A romantic hotwife novel with a deliciously corruptible and reluctant heroine.

*Hotwife **Suspense** By Arnica Butler*

Nila's Long Con

It began with a chance encounter with a man from his wife's past. Rich knew Tennile had some skeletons – of a sexual nature – in her closet, but he never dreamed they were going to come back to haunt them both. Before he can blink, the two of them are embroiled in high-stakes intrigue, with Tennile's reputation and career, their marriage, and a lot of money on the line. There seems to be no way out but to play the game, and Tennile's past might be game-winning asset. In the style of *A Well-Laid Trap*, this is a thrilling hotwife ride that will keep you hooked until the end.

A Well-Laid Trap

It all begins when Patrick is convinced he saw his wife with another man at a downtown bar.

He begins to investigate. But the more Patrick uncovers about Jordan's activities, the less he understands.

The biggest problem is, Patrick can't decide how he really feels. On the one hand, his wife seems to be betraying him, and on the other, his sex life has reached a scorching pinnacle he never thought possible.

But he had better hold on to his hat, because when he finds out the truth, things will get much, much hotter than he might have ever imagined...

*Fun **Summer Swinger** Titles:*

Clothing Optional

Sy Price and his wife find themselves in an unexpected situation when their Belize vacation resort turns out to be “Clothing Optional.” They’re even more surprised to find out that “Clothing Optional” is code for quite a bit more. They decide to make the best of things and enjoy their vacation. But there are a lot more surprises in store for Sy when Jackie decides to fully embrace the hotel amenities...

A Summer Vacation

Poor Keith. He's been condemned to a campy cruise with his family and friends. Worse yet, he suspects something is going on between his wife and bad-boy Hank, the husband of a family friend his wife has invited along. Keith's in for a very big surprise – and much more naughty, adult fun than he expected on this cruise – when he finds out what's really going on.

Try To Have Some Fun

Helena and Steve's wealthy, sexy, swinger friends have returned to town. Helena has a child- and work-free stretch of summer ahead of her. There's nothing stopping her from spending her days relaxing by their spectacular pool. No reason not to borrow a tiny bikini, or to maybe sunbathe topless.

Or skinny-dip at one of their wild parties.

One thing, though, will probably lead to another...

Explore darker themes by Arnica Butler:

Well-Constructed Affairs

As a hot female construction engineer, John's wife Adria draws a lot of attention at the job site. Which isn't all bad. But when Adria opens the door for him to tell her about his sexual fantasies, he doesn't realize she has opened the door on her own – very dark – fantasy as well. A fantasy she hasn't shared with anyone until now. The couple are off on an exploration of their desires...but is their marriage well-constructed enough to withstand the forces of their fantasies?

Nikita Gets In Too Deep

When Cole and his wife Nik arrive at their usual vacation spot in dull Cape Breton, they're taken by surprise by the most unlikely of next-door neighbors: ultra-sexy Paige and wealthy, commanding Mitch. And these new neighbors are full of surprises. Cole and Nik embark on new adventures in their marriage, trying new things and pushing boundaries they'd never even discussed. It's invigorating, but Cole can't help but wonder if his transformed wife hasn't gotten herself in too deep...

A Gamble: The Making of A Hotwife

Ryan is just an average guy, coaxing his sweet, beautiful wife Victoria into playing into his hotwife fantasy – even if they're just pretending. But a trip to Vegas with his co-worker Brad and his sexy wife Irena turns Ryan's life upside-down. To help Ryan, Brad makes a proposal that could change everything...but it all centers on Victoria's innocence. How far will Victoria go to save what she holds most dear, now that her virtues, her love for Ryan, their marriage, Ryan's desires, and even their finances all hang in the balance? This is a 52,000-word novel about risk and romance, filled to the brim with the hard, steamy scenes you love. Please enjoy!

A Dark Place: Cuckolded In Lagos

Three people are carving out their fortunes in Africa's largest city, but each of them holds a deeper, darker desire. What is the secret desire of the angelic Charlotte, who finds all men's eyes on her after dark in Lagos? What about Andrew, who keeps a secret hunger so buried perhaps he doesn't admit it even to himself? And what could be darker than Clement Ambode's already shadowy “*reliability*” as an all-purpose contractor in the underbelly of Lagos?

Charlotte, Andrew, and Clement will find themselves in a very dark place when their worlds collide in this ultra-sexy, novella-length cuckold story.

